“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Madhya-līlā

Chapter 16

The Journey to Gauḍa Once Again

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the «Anubhāṣya», 2026 — draft)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya

Summary. When Mahāprabhu wished to go to Vṛndāvana, Rāmānanda and Sārvabhauma raised all kinds of obstacles. Meanwhile, in the third year, the Gauḍīya devotees came to Nīlācala. This time the wives of the Vaiṣṇavas brought from Bengal many kinds of food that He loved, to invite Śrīman Mahāprabhu and feed Him. When they reached Śrī Kṣetra, Mahāprabhu honored them by sending them garlands. That year too the Guṇḍicā temple was washed and the other services were done as before. When the four months of Cāturmāsya had passed, the devotees began to leave for home. Mahāprabhu forbade Nityānanda Prabhu to come to Nīlācala every year. At the question of the residents of Kulīnagrāma He again described the marks of a Vaiṣṇava. That year Vidyānidhi stayed in Nīlācala and saw the Oḍana-ṣaṣṭhī festival. When the devotees had taken leave, Mahāprabhu showed His firm resolve to go to Vṛndāvana and set out on the day of Vijayā-daśamī. King Pratāparudra made many arrangements along Mahāprabhu's way. After they crossed the river Citrotpalā, Rāmānanda, Maṅgarāja (Mardarāja?) and Haricandana went along with Mahāprabhu. Mahāprabhu asked Gadādhara Paṇḍita to go back to Nīlācala, but he would not listen. From Kaṭaka Mahāprabhu bound the Paṇḍita Gosvāmī by an oath and sent him to Śrī Puruṣottama, and at Bhadraka He bade farewell to Rāmānanda. Then, reaching the border of the Oḍra country, He traveled by boat as far as Pāṇihāṭi with the help of a *yavana* governor. After that the Lord went from the house of Rāghava Paṇḍita by way of Kumārahaṭṭa to the village of Kuliyā and freed many people from their offenses. From there He went to Rāmakeli and accepted Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Sanātana. Turning

back from Rāmakeli, He instructed Raghunātha dāsa and sent him home. Coming once more to Nīlācala, the Lord began to deliberate about going to Vṛndāvana alone.

Having come to Gauḍa, Gaurasundara devotes Himself to delivering the people —

গৌড়োদ্যানং গৌরমেঘঃ সিঞ্চন্স্বালোকনামৃতৈঃ ।
ভবাগ্নিদগ্ধজনতা-বীরুধঃ সমজীবয়ৎ ॥ ১ ॥

gauḍodyānaṁ gaura-meghaḥ
the garden of Gauḍa the Gaura-cloud
siñcan svālokanāmṛtaiḥ
sprinkling with the nectar of His glances
bhavāgni-dagdha-janatā-
by the fire of worldly existence scorched of the people
vīrudhaḥ samajīvayat
the creepers revived

1 Sprinkling the garden of Gauḍa with the nectar of His glances, the cloud that is Gaura revived the people — creepers scorched by the fire of worldly existence.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
In the garden of Gauḍa the cloud in the form of Gaura sprinkled the nectar of His glance on the creepers — the multitudes of people burned in the forest fire of worldly existence — and brought them back to life.

Anubhāṣya.
gaura-meghaḥ (the cloud, Śrī Gaura) **svālokanāmṛtaiḥ** (with the nectar of His own glance) **gauḍodyānaṁ** (the garden, the land of Gauḍa) **siñcan** (sprinkling) **bhavāgni-dagdha-janatā-vīrudhaḥ** (the creepers, the multitudes of people burned by the forest fire of worldly existence) **samajīvayat** (brought to life).

জয় জয় গৌরচন্দ্র জয় নিত্যানন্দ ।
জয়াদ্বৈতচন্দ্র জয় গৌরভক্তবৃন্দ ॥ ২ ॥

jaya jaya gauracandra jaya nityānanda
glory glory to Gauracandra glory to Nityānanda
jayādvaita-candra jaya gaura-bhakta-vṛnda
glory to Advaitacandra glory of Gaura the devotees to the multitude

2 Glory, glory to Gauracandra! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura![1]

The Lord wishes to go to Vṛndāvana; the king's dismay —

প্রভুর হইল ইচ্ছা যাইতে বৃন্দাবন ।
শুনিয়া প্রতাপরুদ্র হইলা বিমন ॥ ৩ ॥

prabhura haila icchā yāite vṛndāvana
of the Lord arose the desire to go to Vṛndāvana
śuniyā pratāparudra hailā vimana
hearing Pratāparudra became downcast

3 The Lord conceived the desire to go to Vṛndāvana, and when Pratāparudra heard of it, he was downcast.

The king calls the Bhaṭṭācārya and Rāya and asks them to hold the Lord back —

সার্ব্বভৌম, রামানন্দ, আনি' দুই জন ।
দুঁহাকে কহেন রাজা বিনয়-বচন ॥ ৪ ॥

sārvabhauma, rāmānanda, āni' dui jana
Sārvabhauma Rāmānanda summoning the two persons
duṁhāke kahena rājā vinaya-vacana
to both speaks the king humble words

4 The king summoned the two of them, Sārvabhauma and Rāmānanda, and spoke to them humbly:

নীলাদ্রি ছাড়ি' প্রভুর মন অন্যত্র যাইতে ।
তোমরা করহ যত্ন তাঁহারে রাখিতে ॥ ৫ ॥

nīlādri chāḍi' prabhura mana anyatra yāite
Nīlādri leaving of the Lord the mind elsewhere to go
tomarā karaha yatna tāṁhāre rākhite
you make effort Him to keep

5 "The Lord has a mind to leave Nīlādri and go elsewhere. Please make every effort to keep Him here.

তাঁহা বিনা এই রাজ্য মোরে নাহি ভায় ।
গোসাঞি রাখিতে করহ নানা উপায় ॥ ৬ ॥

tāṁhā vinā ei rājya more nāhi bhāya
Him without this kingdom to me not is pleasing
gosāñi rākhite karaha nānā upāya
the Gosāñi to keep employ various means

6 Without Him this kingdom gives me no pleasure. Use every means to keep the Gosāñi here."

The Lord consults Rāya and the Bhaṭṭācārya about going to Vṛndāvana —

রামানন্দ, সার্ব্বভৌম, দুইজনা-স্থানে ।
তবে যুক্তি করে প্রভু — 'যাব বৃন্দাবনে' ॥ ৭ ॥

rāmānanda, sārvabhauma, dui-janā-sthāne
Rāmānanda Sārvabhauma with the two
tabe yukti kare prabhu — 'yāba vṛndāvane'
then counsel takes the Lord — "I will go to Vṛndāvana"

7 Then the Lord took counsel with the two of them, Rāmānanda and Sārvabhauma: "I will go to Vṛndāvana."

Fearing separation, the two divert the Lord with persuasion and hold Him back —

দুঁহে কহে, — রথযাত্রা কর দরশন ।
কার্ত্তিক আইলে, তবে করিহ গমন ॥ ৮ ॥

duṁhe kahe, — ratha-yātrā kara daraśana
the two say — the Ratha-yātrā do seeing
kārtika āile, tabe kariha gamana
Kārtika when it comes then make departure

8 Both of them said, “See the Ratha-yātrā first; when Kārtika comes, then You may go.”

কার্ত্তিক আইলে কহে, — এবে মহা-শীত ।
দোলযাত্রা দেখি’ যাও, — এই ভাল রীত ॥ ৯ ॥

kārtika āile kahe, — ebe mahā-śīta
Kārtika when it came they say — now great cold
dola-yātrā dekhi’ yāo, — ei bhāla rīta
the Dola-yātrā having seen go — this good way

9 When Kārtika came, they said, “Now it is bitterly cold. See the Dola-yātrā and then go — that is the proper way.”

আজি-কালি করি’ উঠায় বিবিধ উপায় ।
যাইতে সম্মতি না দেয় বিচ্ছেদের ভয় ॥ ১০ ॥

āji-kāli kari’ uṭhāya vividha upāya
today–tomorrow saying raise various pretexts
yāite sammati nā deya vicchedera bhaya
to going consent not give of separation out of fear

10 Saying “today, tomorrow,” they raised one pretext after another; afraid of separation, they would not consent to His going.

Though independent, Bhagavān is subject to His devotees —

যদ্যপি স্বতন্ত্র প্রভু নহে নিবারণ ।
ভক্ত-ইচ্ছা বিনা প্রভু না করে গমন ॥ ১১ ॥

yadyapi svatantra prabhu nahe nivāraṇa
although independent the Lord not is to be stopped
bhakta-icchā vinā prabhu nā kare gamana
the devotees' wish without the Lord not makes departure

11 Although the Lord is independent and no one can stop Him, He would not leave without the consent of His devotees.

In the third year the Gauḍīyas long to see the Lord —

তৃতীয় বৎসরে সব গৌড়ের ভক্তগণ ।
নীলাচলে চলিতে সবার হৈল মন ॥ ১২ ॥

tṛtīya vatsare saba gauḍera bhakta-gaṇa
in the third year all of Gauḍa the devotees
nīlācale calite sabāra haila mana
to Nīlācala to go of all arose the wish

12 In the third year all the devotees of Gauḍa resolved to go to Nīlācala.

All go to the venerable Advaitācārya; Advaita sets out for Purī —

সবে মেলি' গেলা অদ্বৈত-আচার্য্যের পাশে ।
প্রভু দেখিতে আচার্য্য চলিলা উল্লাসে ॥ ১৩ ॥

sabe meli' gelā advaita-ācāryera pāśe
all gathering went Advaita Ācārya's to the side
prabhu dekhite ācārya calilā ullāse
the Lord to see the Ācārya set out joyfully

13 They all gathered and went to Advaita Ācārya, and the Ācārya joyfully set out to see the Lord.

Despite the Lord's prohibition, Nitāi, who loves the Lord, goes to Purī to see Him —

যদ্যপি প্রভুর আজ্ঞা গৌড়েতে রহিতে ।
নিত্যানন্দ-প্রভুকে প্রেমভক্তি-প্রকাশিতে ॥ ১৪ ॥

তথাপি চলিলা মহাপ্রভুরে দেখিতে ।
নিত্যানন্দের প্রেম-চেষ্টা কে পারে বুঝিতে ॥ ১৫ ॥

yadyapi prabhura ājñā gauḍete rahite
although of the Lord the order in Gauḍa to stay
nityānanda-prabhuke prema-bhakti-prakāśite
to Nityānanda Prabhu prema-bhakti to make manifest
tathāpi calilā mahāprabhure dekhite
nevertheless set out Mahāprabhu to see
nityānandera prema-ceṣṭā ke pāre bujhite
Nityānanda's loving dealings who can understand

14–15 Although the Lord had ordered Nityānanda Prabhu to stay in Gauḍa and reveal *prema-bhakti*, Nityānanda set out all the same to see Mahāprabhu. Who can understand the ways of His love?

Rāghava of Pāṇihāṭi, Satyarāja and others of Kulīnagrāma set out —

আচার্য্যরত্ন, বিদ্যানিধি, শ্রীবাস, রামাই ।
বাসুদেব, মুরারি, গোবিন্দাদি তিন-ভাই ॥ ১৬ ॥

রাঘব-পণ্ডিত নিজ-ঝালি সাজাঞা ।
কুলীন-গ্রামবাসী চলে পট্টডোরী লঞা ॥ ১৭ ॥

ācāryaratna, vidyānidhi, śrīvāsa, rāmāi
Ācāryaratna Vidyānidhi Śrīvāsa Rāmāi
vāsudeva, murāri, govindādi tina-bhāi
Vāsudeva Murāri Govinda and the others the three brothers
rāghava-paṇḍita nija-jhāli sājāñā
Rāghava Paṇḍita his own bags having prepared
kulīna-grāma-vāsī cale paṭṭa-ḍorī lañā
the residents of Kulīna-grāma go silk ropes taking

16–17 Ācāryaratna, Vidyānidhi, Śrīvāsa, Rāmāi, Vāsudeva, Murāri, and Govinda with his two brothers set out. Rāghava Paṇḍita packed his bags (*jhāli*) for the journey, and the residents of Kulīna-grāma came bringing silk ropes.

Narahari and others set out from Khaṇḍa —

খণ্ডবাসী নরহরি, শ্রীরঘুনন্দন ।
সর্ব্ব-ভক্ত চলে, তার কে করে গণন ॥ ১৮ ॥

khaṇḍa-vāsī narahari, śrī-raghunandana
the resident of Khaṇḍa Narahari Śrī Raghunandana
sarva-bhakta cale, tāra ke kare gaṇana
all the devotees go of them who makes a count

18 Narahari of Khaṇḍa and Śrī Raghunandana came too. All the devotees set out — who can count them?

Śivānanda, who knows the way, looks after and leads them all —

শিবানন্দ-সেন করে ঘাটি সমাধান ।
সবারে পালন করি' সুখে লঞা যান ॥ ১৯ ॥

śivānanda-sena kare ghāṭi samādhāna
Śivānanda Sena does at the toll stations the settling
sabāre pālana kari' sukhe lañā yāna
all care taking happily leading goes

19 Śivānanda Sena settled the tolls at the crossings; taking care of everyone, he led them happily along.

Anubhāṣya.
"Settling matters at the toll stations (*ghāṭi*)" means making up for a shortage of money, or paying the toll (*kara*) that travelers must pay on the appointed roads and at the river crossings.

সবার সর্ব্বকার্য্য করেন, দেন বাসা-স্থান ।
শিবানন্দ জানে উড়িয়া-পথের সন্ধান ॥ ২০ ॥

sabāra sarva-kārya karena, dena vāsā-sthāna
of all all the affairs he does gives lodging places
śivānanda jāne uḍiyā-pathera sandhāna
Śivānanda knows of the Oḍiyā roads the details

20 He attended to everyone's needs and found them places to stay, for Śivānanda knew the roads through Orissa well.

The wives of the Vaiṣṇavas go to see the Lord — (1) the journey of Advaita's wife —

সে বৎসর প্রভু দেখিতে সব ঠাকুরাণী ।
চলিলা আচার্য্য-সঙ্গে অচ্যুত-জননী ॥ ২১ ॥

se vatsara prabhu dekhite saba ṭhākurāṇī
that year the Lord to see all the ladies
calilā ācārya-saṅge acyuta-jananī
went with the Ācārya Acyuta's mother

21 That year all the ladies went to see the Lord. Acyuta's mother went with the Ācārya.

(2) The journey of Śrīvāsa's wife and (3) of Śivānanda's wife —

শ্রীবাস-পণ্ডিত-সঙ্গে চলিলা মালিনী ।
শিবানন্দ-সঙ্গে চলে তাঁহার গৃহিণী ॥ ২২ ॥

śrīvāsa-paṇḍita-saṅge calilā mālinī
with Śrīvāsa Paṇḍita went Mālinī
śivānanda-saṅge cale tāṁhāra gṛhiṇī
with Śivānanda goes his wife

22 Mālinī went with Śrīvāsa Paṇḍita, and Śivānanda's wife went with him.

The journey of Caitanya dāsa, Śivānanda's son —

শিবানন্দের বালক, নাম — চৈতন্য-দাস ।
তিঁহো চলিয়াছে প্রভুরে দেখিতে উল্লাস ॥ ২৩ ॥

śivānandera bālaka, nāma — caitanya-dāsa
Śivānanda's son name — Caitanya dāsa
tiṁho caliyāche prabhure dekhite ullāsa
he set out the Lord to see joyfully

23 Śivānanda's son, named Caitanya dāsa, also set out joyfully to see the Lord.

(4) The journey of Candraśekhara's wife —

আচার্য্যরত্ন-সঙ্গে চলে তাঁহার গৃহিণী ।
তাঁহার প্রেমের কথা কহিতে না জানি ॥ ২৪ ॥

ācāryaratna-saṅge cale tāṁhāra gṛhiṇī
with Ācāryaratna goes his wife
tāṁhāra premera kathā kahite nā jāni
of that one of the love the account to tell not I know how

24 Ācāryaratna's wife went with him. I do not know how to describe her love.[2]

For the Lord's service they take along foods and other things He loves —

সব ঠাকুরাণী মহাপ্রভুকে ভিক্ষা দিতে ।
প্রভুর নানা প্রিয় দ্রব্য নিল ঘর হৈতে ॥ ২৫ ॥

saba ṭhākurāṇī mahāprabhuke bhikṣā dite
all the ladies to Mahāprabhu a meal to give
prabhura nānā priya dravya nila ghara haite
of the Lord various favourite foods took from home

25 To offer Mahāprabhu a meal, all the ladies brought from home many of the Lord's favourite foods.

Śivānanda takes care of everything —

শিবানন্দ-সেন করে সব সমাধান ।
ঘাটিয়াল প্রবোধি' দেন সবারে বাসা-স্থান ॥ ২৬ ॥

śivānanda-sena kare saba samādhāna
Śivānanda Sena does all the arranging
ghāṭiyāla prabodhi' dena sabāre vāsā-sthāna
the toll collectors pacifying gives to all lodging places

26 Śivānanda Sena arranged everything. He pacified the toll collectors (*ghāṭiyāla*) and found lodgings for everyone.

Anubhāṣya.

The *ghāṭiyāls* were inspectors on the road. They unjustly and unlawfully exacted extra money from travelers. Śivānanda would give them what was rightfully due to them and ask them to give up their excessive demands.

ভক্ষ্য দিয়া করেন সবার সর্ব্বত্র পালনে ।
পরম আনন্দে যান প্রভুর দরশনে ॥ ২৭ ॥

bhakṣya diyā karena sabāra sarvatra pālane
food giving does of all everywhere the care
parama ānande yāna prabhura daraśane
in supreme bliss goes of the Lord to the sight

27 Everywhere he looked after them all and gave them food, and he went on in supreme bliss to see the Lord.

At Remuṇā all see Gopīnātha; following Mādhava Purī, Advaita sings and dances —

রেমুণায় আসিয়া কৈল গোপীনাথ দরশন ।
আচার্য্য করিল তাঁহা কীর্ত্তন, নর্ত্তন ॥ ২৮ ॥

remuṇāya āsiyā kaila gopīnātha daraśana
to Remuṇā coming they made of Gopīnātha darśana
ācārya karila tāṁhā kīrtana, nartana
the Ācārya did there kīrtana dancing

28 Coming to Remuṇā, they had *darśana* of Gopīnātha, and there the Ācārya sang and danced.

The servitors, who knew Nityānanda from before, welcome Him —

নিত্যানন্দের পরিচয় সব-লোক-সনে ।
বহুত সম্মান আসি' কৈল সেবকগণে ॥ ২৯ ॥

nityānandera paricaya saba-loka-sane
Nityānanda's acquaintance with all the people
bahuta sammāna āsi' kaila sevaka-gaṇe
great honour coming showed the servants

29 Nityānanda was known to all the people there, and the temple servants came and showed Him great honour.

*All spend the night there and honor the *kṣīra-prasāda* —*

সেই রাত্রি সব মহান্ত তাহাঞি রহিলা ।
বার ক্ষীর আনি' আগে সেবক ধরিলা ॥ ৩০ ॥

sei rātri saba mahānta tāhāñi rahilā
that night all the great souls right there stayed
bāra kṣīra āni' āge sevaka dharilā
twelve pots of kṣīra bringing before the servant placed

30 All those great souls stayed there that night, and a servant brought twelve pots of *kṣīra* (sweet rice) and set them before the devotees.

ক্ষীর বাঁটি' সবারে দিল প্রভু-নিত্যানন্দ ।
ক্ষীর-প্রসাদ পাঞা সবার বাড়িল আনন্দ ॥ ৩১ ॥

kṣīra bāṁṭi' sabāre dila prabhu-nityānanda
the kṣīra dividing to all gave Nityānanda Prabhu
kṣīra-prasāda pāñā sabāra bāḍila ānanda
the kṣīra prasāda receiving of all increased the bliss

31 Nityānanda Prabhu divided the *kṣīra* and gave it to everyone, and receiving that *kṣīra-prasāda*, they were all filled with joy.

Nityānanda tells how Śrī Purī, Gopāla and Gopīnātha came —

মাধবপুরীর কথা, গোপাল-স্থাপন ।
তাঁহারে গোপাল যৈছে মাগিল চন্দন ॥ ৩২ ॥

mādhava-purīra kathā, gopāla-sthāpana
of Mādhava Purī the story of Gopāla the installation
tāṁhāre gopāla yaiche māgila candana
from him Gopāla how asked for sandalwood

32 The story of Mādhava Purī, the installation of Gopāla, how Gopāla asked him for sandalwood,[3]

The devotees had heard this account from Mahāprabhu's lips on the previous journey; the devotees' joy —

তাঁর লাগি' গোপীনাথ ক্ষীর চুরি কৈল ।
মহাপ্রভুর মুখে আগে এ কথা শুনিল ॥ ৩৩ ॥

tāṁra lāgi' gopīnātha kṣīra curi kaila
him for the sake of Gopīnātha the kṣīra theft made
mahāprabhura mukhe āge e kathā śunila
of Mahāprabhu from the mouth before this story they had heard

33 and how Gopīnātha stole *kṣīra* for his sake — they had heard this story earlier from Mahāprabhu's own mouth.

সেই কথা সবার মধ্যে কহে নিত্যানন্দ ।
শুনিয়া বৈষ্ণবমনে বাড়িল আনন্দ ॥ ৩৪ ॥

sei kathā sabāra madhye kahe nityānanda
that story all among tells Nityānanda
śuniyā vaiṣṇavamane bāḍila ānanda
hearing in the hearts of the Vaiṣṇavas increased the bliss

34 Now Nityānanda told that story among them all, and the Vaiṣṇavas' hearts swelled with joy as they listened.

Anubhāṣya.

"From Mahāprabhu's lips." Mahāprabhu had earlier heard this from the lips of Śrīpāda Īśvara Purī (Madhya 4.18). After staying a few days in Śāntipura, in Śrī Advaita's house, He set out for Nīlācala with Nityānanda, Jagadānanda, Dāmodara Paṇḍita and Mukunda. On reaching Remuṇā He told them the story of Śrī

Mādhavendra Purī, of Giridhārī Gopāla of Vṛndāvana and of Kṣīra-corā Gopīnātha of Remuṇā (see Madhya 4.19–190).

All come to Kaṭaka and see Sākṣi-gopāla; Nitāi tells the story of Sākṣi-gopāla —

এইমত চলি' চলি' কটক আইলা ।
সাক্ষীগোপাল দেখি' সবে সে দিন রহিলা ॥ ৩৫ ॥

ei mata cali' cali' kaṭaka āilā
in this way going on going on to Kaṭaka they came
sākṣī-gopāla dekhi' sabe se dina rahilā
Sākṣi-gopāla seeing all that day stayed

35 Travelling on in this way, they came to Kaṭaka. There they saw Sākṣi-gopāla and stayed that day.

সাক্ষীগোপালের কথা কহে নিত্যানন্দ ।
শুনিয়া বৈষ্ণব-মনে বাড়িল আনন্দ ॥ ৩৬ ॥

sākṣī-gopālera kathā kahe nityānanda
of Sākṣi-gopāla the story tells Nityānanda
śuniyā vaiṣṇava-mane bāḍila ānanda
hearing in the hearts of the Vaiṣṇavas increased the bliss

36 Nityānanda told the story of Sākṣi-gopāla, and the Vaiṣṇavas' hearts swelled with joy as they listened.

Anubhāṣya.
For the story of Sākṣi-gopāla see Madhya 5.8–138.

Eager to see the Lord, all hurry to Purī —

প্রভুকে মিলিতে সবার উৎকণ্ঠা অন্তরে ।
শীঘ্র করি' আইলা সবে শ্রীনীলাচলে ॥ ৩৭ ॥

prabhuke milite sabāra utkaṇṭhā antare
the Lord to meet of all eagerness in the heart
śīghra kari' āilā sabe śrī-nīlācale
quickly making came all to Śrī Nīlācala

37 Their hearts were all eager to meet the Lord, so they hurried on to Śrī Nīlācala.

Hearing that the Gauḍīya devotees have reached Āṭhāranālā, the Lord sends garlands with Govinda to welcome them —

আঠারনালাকে আইলা গোসাঞি শুনিয়া ।
দুইমালা পাঠাইলা গোবিন্দ হাতে দিয়া ॥ ৩৮ ॥

āṭhāranālāke āilā gosāñi śuniyā
at Āṭhāranālā they have come the Gosāñi hearing
duimālā pāṭhāilā govinda hāte diyā
two garlands sent Govinda's in the hand placing

38 Hearing that they had reached Āṭhāranālā, the Gosāñi placed two garlands in Govinda's hands and sent him to them.

Anubhāṣya.
Āṭhāranālā is a bridge on the outskirts of the town of Śrī Puruṣottama.

Nitāi and Advaita put on the garlands —

দুই মালা গোবিন্দ দুই জনে পরাইল ।
অদ্বৈত, অবধূত-গোসাঞি বড় সুখ পাইল ॥ ৩৯ ॥

dui mālā govinda dui jane parāila
the two garlands Govinda on the two persons put
advaita, avadhūta-gosāñi baḍa sukha pāila
Advaita the Avadhūta Gosāñi great happiness felt

39 Govinda put the two garlands on the two of them, and Advaita and the Avadhūta Gosāñi (Nityānanda) were overjoyed.

From there, as they set out, all begin to dance and sing —

তাহাঞি আরম্ভ কৈল কৃষ্ণ-সংকীর্ত্তন ।
নাচিতে নাচিতে চলি' আইলা দুইজন ॥ ৪০ ॥

tāhāñi ārambha kaila kṛṣṇa-saṅkīrtana
right there beginning made of Kṛṣṇa-saṅkīrtana
nācite nācite cali' āilā dui-jana
dancing dancing going came the two

40 Right there they began Kṛṣṇa-saṅkīrtana, and the two of them came on, dancing all the way.

The Lord again sends garlands through Svarūpa and others —

পুনঃ মালা দিয়া স্বরূপাদি নিজগণে ।
আগু বাড়ি' পাঠাইল শচীর নন্দনে ॥ ৪১ ॥

punaḥ mālā diyā svarūpādi nija-gaṇe
again garlands giving to Svarūpa and the others to His own men
āgu bāḍi' pāṭhāila śacīra nandane
ahead sending forward sent of Śacī by the son

41 Then Śacī's son gave garlands to Svarūpa and His other associates and sent them ahead.

Meeting everyone at Narendra Lake, they give them garlands —

নরেন্দ্র আসিয়া তাঁহা সবারে মিলিলা ।
মহাপ্রভুর দত্ত মালা সবারে পরাইলা ॥ ৪২ ॥

narendra āsiyā tāṁhā sabāre mililā
to Narendra coming there with all they met
mahāprabhura datta mālā sabāre parāilā
by Mahāprabhu given the garlands on all they put

42 Coming to Narendra, they met everyone there and put Mahāprabhu's garlands on them all.

The Lord Himself comes to the Lion Gate and meets all the devotees —

সিংহদ্বার-নিকটে আইলা শুনি' গৌররায় ।
আপনে আসিয়া প্রভু মিলিলা সবায় ॥ ৪৩ ॥

siṁha-dvāra-nikaṭe āilā śuni' gaurarāya
near the Siṁha-dvāra they have come hearing Gaurarāya
āpane āsiyā prabhu mililā sabāya
Himself coming the Lord met with all

43 When Gaurarāya heard that they had reached the Siṁha-dvāra, the Lord came Himself and met them all.

After seeing Jagannātha, the Lord goes home with all the devotees —

সবা লঞা কৈল জগন্নাথ-দরশন ।
সবা লঞা আইলা পুনঃ আপন-ভবন ॥ ৪৪ ॥

sabā lañā kaila jagannātha-daraśana
all taking He made Jagannātha-darśana
sabā lañā āilā punaḥ āpana-bhavana
all taking came again to His own residence

44 Taking them all with Him, He had *darśana* of Jagannātha, and then He brought them all back to His own residence.

*The Lord gives everyone the *prasāda* brought by Vāṇīnātha and Kāśī Miśra —*

বাণীনাথ, কাশীমিশ্র প্রসাদ আনিল ।
স্বহস্তে সবারে প্রভু প্রসাদ খাওয়াইল ॥ ৪৫ ॥

vāṇīnātha, kāśī-miśra prasāda ānila
Vāṇīnātha Kāśī Miśra prasāda brought
svahaste sabāre prabhu prasāda khāoyāila
with His own hand all the Lord prasāda fed

45 Vāṇīnātha and Kāśī Miśra brought *prasāda*, and the Lord served it to everyone with His own hand.

Each is given the lodging he had the year before, and so on —

পূর্ব্ব-বৎসরে যাঁর যেই বাসা-স্থান ।
তাঁহা সবা পাঠাঞা করাইল বিশ্রাম ॥ ৪৬ ॥

pūrva-vatsare yāṁra yei vāsā-sthāna
in the previous year whose whatever lodging place
tāṁhā sabā pāṭhāñā karāila viśrāma
there all sending made rest

46 He sent each of them to the lodging they had had the year before and let them rest.

The devotees spend four months in Purī with the Lord —

এইমত ভক্তগণ রহিলা চারি মাস ।
প্রভুর সহিত করে কীর্ত্তন-বিলাস ॥ ৪৭ ॥

ei mata bhakta-gaṇa rahilā cāri māsa
in this way the devotees stayed four months
prabhura sahita kare kīrtana-vilāsa
the Lord with do the pastimes of kīrtana

47 In this way the devotees stayed four months, enjoying the pastimes of *kīrtana* with the Lord.

Before the Ratha-yātrā all cleanse the Guṇḍicā temple —

পূর্ব্ববৎ রথযাত্রা-কাল যবে আইল ।
সবা লঞা গুণ্ডিচা-মন্দির প্রক্ষালিল ॥ ৪৮ ॥

pūrvavat ratha-yātrā-kāla yabe āila
as before the time of the Ratha-yātrā when came
sabā lañā guṇḍicā-mandira prakṣālila
all taking the Guṇḍicā temple He washed

48 When the time of the Ratha-yātrā came, He took them all, as before, and washed the Guṇḍicā temple.

Satyarāja and others offer Jagannātha silk ropes, as the Lord instructed —

কুলীনগ্রামী পট্টডোরী জগন্নাথে দিল ।
পূর্ব্ববৎ রথ-অগ্রে নর্ত্তন করিল ॥ ৪৯ ॥

kulīna-grāmī paṭṭa-ḍorī jagannāthe dila
the residents of Kulīna-grāma silk ropes to Jagannātha gave
pūrvavat ratha-agre nartana karila
as before in front of the chariot dancing He did

49 The residents of Kulīna-grāma gave silk ropes to Jagannātha, and as before He danced in front of the chariot.

After dancing before the chariot, all rest in the garden —

বহু নৃত্য করি' পুনঃ চলিল উদ্যানে ।
বাপী-তীরে তাঁহা যাই' করিল বিশ্রামে ॥ ৫০ ॥

bahu nṛtya kari' punaḥ calila udyāne
much dancing having done then went to the garden
vāpī-tīre tāṁhā yāi' karila viśrāme
on the bank of the pond there going made rest

50 After dancing a great deal He went to the garden, and there He rested on the bank of the pond.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Vāpī means a well (an *indārā*?), that is, a reservoir.

Anubhāṣya.
"In the garden" means in Jagannātha-vallabha; "on the bank of the *vāpī*" means on the bank of Narendra Lake.

*The *brāhmaṇa* Kṛṣṇadāsa of Rāḍha bathes the Lord (*abhiṣeka*); the Lord's delight —*

রাঢ়ী এক বিপ্র তিঁহো — নিত্যানন্দ-দাস ।
মহা-ভাগ্যবান্ তিঁহো, নাম — কৃষ্ণদাস ॥ ৫১ ॥

rāḍhī eka vipra tiṁho — nityānanda-dāsa
from Rāḍha one brāhmaṇa he — a servant of Nityānanda
mahā-bhāgyavān tiṁho, nāma — kṛṣṇadāsa
most fortunate he name — Kṛṣṇadāsa

51 There was a most fortunate brāhmaṇa from Rāḍha named Kṛṣṇadāsa, a servant of Nityānanda.

ঘট ভরি' প্রভুর তিঁহো অভিষেক কৈল ।
তাঁর অভিষেকে প্রভু মহা-তৃপ্ত হৈল ॥ ৫২ ॥

ghaṭa bhari' prabhura tiṁho abhiṣeka kaila
a pitcher filling of the Lord he bathing did
tāṁra abhiṣeke prabhu mahā-tṛpta haila
his by the bathing the Lord greatly pleased became

52 He filled a pitcher and bathed the Lord, and the Lord was greatly pleased.

*All honor the *prasāda* of the Balagaṇḍi *bhoga* —*

বলগণ্ডি-ভোগের বহু প্রসাদ আইল ।
সবা সঙ্গে মহাপ্রভু প্রসাদ খাইল ॥ ৫৩ ॥

balagaṇḍi-bhogera bahu prasāda āila
of the Balagaṇḍi offering much prasāda came
sabā saṅge mahāprabhu prasāda khāila
all with Mahāprabhu prasāda ate

53 A great deal of *prasāda* came from the Balagaṇḍi offering, and Mahāprabhu honoured it with them all.

All watch the Herā-pañcamī festival —

পূর্ব্ববৎ রথযাত্রা কৈল দরশন ।
হেরাপঞ্চমী-যাত্রা দেখে লঞা ভক্তগণ ॥ ৫৪ ॥

pūrvavat ratha-yātrā kaila daraśana
as before the Ratha-yātrā He made seeing
herā-pañcamī-yātrā dekhe lañā bhakta-gaṇa
the Herā-pañcamī festival sees taking the devotees

54 As before, He watched the Ratha-yātrā, and with His devotees He saw the festival of Herā-pañcamī.

During a storm with rain the Lord alone takes His meal at Advaita's house —

আচার্য্য-গোসাঞি প্রভুর কৈল নিমন্ত্রণ ।
তার মধ্যে কৈল যৈছে ঝড়-বরিষণ ॥ ৫৫ ॥

ācārya-gosāñi prabhura kaila nimantraṇa
Ācārya Gosāñi of the Lord made invitation
tāra madhye kaila yaiche jhaḍa-variṣaṇa
that in the midst of made how a storm of rain

55 Ācārya Gosāñi invited the Lord, and in the midst of it He brought on a storm of wind and rain.

*This is described in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata* —*

বিস্তারি' বর্ণিয়াছেন দাস-বৃন্দাবন ।
শ্রীবাস প্রভুরে তবে কৈল নিমন্ত্রণ ॥ ৫৬ ॥

vistāri' varṇiyāchena dāsa-vṛndāvana
in detail has described Vṛndāvana dāsa
śrīvāsa prabhure tabe kaila nimantraṇa
Śrīvāsa the Lord then made invitation

56 Vṛndāvana dāsa has described this in detail. Then Śrīvāsa invited the Lord.[4]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Caitanya-bhāgavata, Antya-khaṇḍa, chapter 8. Once Śrī Advaita invited Mahāprabhu and thought, “If no other *sannyāsī* comes with the Lord, I shall feed the Lord well.” The other *sannyāsīs* had gone out for their midday rites, and just

then a storm with rain arose. Since they could not come, the Lord came alone and ate Śrī Advaita's rice and vegetables.

Mālinī-devī's service to the Lord —

প্রভুর প্রিয়-ব্যঞ্জন সব রান্ধেন মালিনী ।
‘ভক্ত্যে দাসী’-অভিমান, ‘স্নেহেতে জননী’ ॥ ৫৭ ॥

prabhura priya-vyañjana saba rāndhena mālinī
the Lord’s favourite dishes all cooks Mālinī
‘bhaktye dāsī’-abhimāna, ‘snehete jananī’
“in devotion a maidservant” — such self-conception “in affection a mother”

57 Mālinī cooked all the Lord’s favourite dishes. In devotion she thought of herself as His maidservant; in affection she was His mother.

Candraśekhara's service to the Lord —

আচার্য্যরত্ন-আদি যত মুখ্য ভক্তগণ ।
মধ্যে মধ্যে প্রভুরে করেন নিমন্ত্রণ ॥ ৫৮ ॥

ācāryaratna-ādi yata mukhya bhakta-gaṇa
Ācāryaratna and the others as many chief devotees
madhye madhye prabhure karena nimantraṇa
from time to time the Lord make invitation

58 Ācāryaratna and the other leading devotees invited the Lord from time to time.

When Cāturmāsya is over, secret counsel with Nitāi —

চাতুর্ম্মাস্য-অন্তে পুনঃ নিত্যানন্দে লঞা ।
কিবা যুক্তি করে নিত্য নিভৃতে বসিয়া ॥ ৫৯ ॥

cāturmāsya-ante punaḥ nityānande lañā
at the end of Cāturmāsya again Nityānanda taking
kibā yukti kare nitya nibhṛte vasiyā
some kind of counsel holds daily in private sitting

59 At the end of Cāturmāsya the Lord would again take Nityānanda aside every day and confer with Him in private.

*Advaita recites a mysterious *tarjā* —*

আচার্য্য-গোসাঞি প্রভুকে কহে ঠারে-ঠোরে ।
আচার্য্য তর্জ্জা পড়ে, কেহ বুঝিতে না পারে ॥ ৬০ ॥

ācārya-gosāñi prabhuke kahe ṭhāre-ṭhore
Ācārya Gosāñi to the Lord speaks in hints
ācārya tarjā paḍe, keha bujhite nā pāre
the Ācārya riddles recites anyone to understand not is able

60 Ācārya Gosāñi spoke to the Lord in hints, reciting riddles (*tarjā*) that no one could understand.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Tarjā is speech in *payār* and similar meters that other people cannot easily understand.

*The Lord accepts what the *tarjā* said; Advaita's joy —*

তাঁর মুখ দেখি' হাসে শচীর নন্দন ।
অঙ্গীকার জানি' আচার্য্য করেন নর্ত্তন ॥ ৬১ ॥

tāṁra mukha dekhi' hāse śacīra nandana
his face seeing smiles of Śacī the son
aṅgīkāra jāni' ācārya karena nartana
acceptance knowing the Ācārya does dancing

61 Śacī's son looked at Advaita's face and smiled, and the Ācārya, taking this as the Lord's assent, began to dance.

The talks of Gaura and Advaita are beyond others' understanding; the Lord bids Advaita farewell —

কিবা প্রার্থনা, কিবা আজ্ঞা — কেহ না বুঝিল ।
আলিঙ্গন করি' প্রভু তাঁরে বিদায় দিল ॥ ৬২ ॥

kibā prārthanā, kibā ājñā — keha nā bujhila
whether a prayer whether an order — anyone not understood
āliṅgana kari' prabhu tāṅre vidāya dila
embrace making the Lord him leave gave

62 No one understood whether it was a prayer or an instruction. Then the Lord embraced Him and bade Him farewell.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
What Śrī Advaitācārya prayed for in his *tarjā*, and what Śrī Śacīnandana's smile meant — this no one else could understand.

*Nitāi is instructed not to come to Purī every year but to preach the holy name and *prema* in Gauḍa —*

নিত্যানন্দ কহে প্রভু, — শুনহ, শ্রীপাদ ।
এই আমি মাগি, তুমি করহ প্রসাদ ॥ ৬৩ ॥

nityānanda kahe prabhu, — śunaha, śrīpāda
to Nityānanda says the Lord — listen Śrīpāda
ei āmi māgi, tumi karaha prasāda
this I beg You grant the favour

63 The Lord said to Nityānanda, "Listen, Śrīpāda: I beg this of You — grant Me this favour.

প্রতিবর্ষ নীলাচলে তুমি না আসিবা ।
গৌড়ে রহি' মোর ইচ্ছা সফল করিবা ॥ ৬৪ ॥

prati-varṣa nīlācale tumi nā āsibā
every year to Nīlācala You not should come
gauḍe rahi' mora icchā saphala karibā
in Gauḍa staying My desire fulfilled should make

64 Do not come to Nīlācala every year. Stay in Gauḍa and fulfil My desire.

Through Nitāi the Lord accomplishes a difficult task —

তাঁহা সিদ্ধি করে — হেন অন্যে না দেখিয়ে ।
আমার 'দুষ্কর' কর্ম্ম, তোমা হৈতে হয়ে ॥ ৬৫ ॥

tāṁhā siddhi kare — hena anye nā dekhiye
that fulfilment does — such another not I see
āmāra 'duṣkara' karma, tomā haite haye
My difficult work You from is accomplished

65 I see no one else who could accomplish it. My difficult work can be done only by You."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
In Gauḍa, in Mahāprabhu's absence, no one but Śrī Prabhu Nityānanda can fulfill His purpose — to give the holy name and *prema* to everyone, down to the *caṇḍālas*.

Nityānanda Prabhu, Mahāprabhu's devotee —

নিত্যানন্দ কহে, — আমি 'দেহ' তুমি 'প্রাণ' ।
'দেহ' 'প্রাণ' ভিন্ন নহে, — এই ত' প্রমাণ ॥ ৬৬ ॥

nityānanda kahe, — āmi 'deha' tumi 'prāṇa'
Nityānanda says — I the body You the life
'deha' 'prāṇa' bhinna nahe, — ei ta' pramāṇa
the body the life different not are — this indeed the proof

66 Nityānanda said, "I am the body and You are the life. Body and life are not separate; that is beyond doubt.

অচিন্ত্যশক্ত্যে কর তুমি তাহার ঘটন ।
যে করাহ, সেই করি, নাহিক নিয়ম ॥ ৬৭ ॥

acintya-śaktye kara tumi tāhāra ghaṭana
by inconceivable potency bring about You of that the accomplishment
ye karāha, sei kari, nāhika niyama
whatever You make Me do that I do there is no rule

67 Yet by Your inconceivable potency You keep them apart. Whatever You have Me do, that I do; there is no rule here."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Nityānanda said, "I am the body, You are the life; these two are never separate. But that we live apart — You in Nīlācala and I in Gauḍa — comes about only by Your inconceivable power."

The Lord bids farewell to Nitāi and to all the other devotees —

তাঁরে বিদায় দিল প্রভু করি' আলিঙ্গন ।
এইমত বিদায় দিল সব ভক্তগণ ॥ ৬৮ ॥

tāṁre vidāya dila prabhu kari' āliṅgana
Him leave gave the Lord making an embrace
ei mata vidāya dila saba bhakta-gaṇa
in this way leave gave all the devotees

68 The Lord embraced Him and bade Him farewell, and in the same way He bade farewell to all the devotees.

As in the previous year, Satyarāja and others ask the Lord about their duty —

কুলীনগ্রামী পূর্ব্ববৎ কৈল নিবেদন ।
প্রভু, আজ্ঞা কর, — আমার কর্তব্য সাধন ॥ ৬৯ ॥

kulīna-grāmī pūrvavat kaila nivedana
the resident of Kulīna-grāma as before made a submission
prabhu, ājñā kara, — āmāra kartavya sādhana
Lord an order give — my duty practice

69 As before, a resident of Kulīna-grāma submitted, "Lord, please instruct me: what is my duty, my practice?"

The Lord's answer —

প্রভু কহে, — বৈষ্ণব সেবা, নাম-সংকীর্ত্তন ।
দুই কর, শীঘ্র পাবে শ্রীকৃষ্ণ-চরণ ॥ ৭০ ॥

prabhu kahe, — vaiṣṇava sevā, nāma-saṅkīrtana
the Lord says — of the Vaiṣṇavas service saṅkīrtana of the name
dui kara, śīghra pābe śrī-kṛṣṇa-caraṇa
two do quickly you will obtain the feet of Śrī Kṛṣṇa

70 The Lord said, “Serve the Vaiṣṇavas and chant the holy name in *saṅkīrtana*. Do these two, and you will quickly attain the feet of Śrī Kṛṣṇa.”

Satyarāja and others ask the Lord the marks of a Vaiṣṇava —

তেঁহো কহে, — কে বৈষ্ণব, কি তাঁর লক্ষণ ?
তবে হাসি’ কহে প্রভু জানি’ তাঁর মন ॥ ৭১ ॥

temṁho kahe, — ke vaiṣṇava, ki tāṁra lakṣaṇa?
he says — who a Vaiṣṇava what his symptom
tabe hāsi’ kahe prabhu jāni’ tāṁra mana
then smiling says the Lord knowing his mind

71 He asked, “Who is a Vaiṣṇava? What are his marks?” Then the Lord, knowing his mind, smiled and said,

The Lord indicates the marks of the “intermediate Vaiṣṇava” —

কৃষ্ণনাম নিরন্তর যাঁহার বদনে ।
সেই বৈষ্ণব-শ্রেষ্ঠ, ভজ তাঁহার চরণে ॥ ৭২ ॥

kṛṣṇa-nāma nirantara yāṁhāra vadane
the name of Kṛṣṇa constantly whose in the mouth
sei vaiṣṇava-śreṣṭha, bhaja tāṁhāra caraṇe
he the best of the Vaiṣṇavas worship his feet

72 “One on whose lips the name of Kṛṣṇa is always present is the best of Vaiṣṇavas. Worship his feet.”

Anubhāṣya.
Know the Vaiṣṇava on whose lips the name of Śrī Kṛṣṇa sounds “constantly” to be better than “the junior (*kaniṣṭha*) Vaiṣṇava of tender faith, who utters the name of Kṛṣṇa only once” — that is, know him to be an “intermediate *bhāgavata*”

(*madhyama-bhāgavata*), and serve his feet. In the *Upadeśāmṛta*, with the words *praṇatibhiś ca bhajantam īśam*, Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī instructs *bhāgavatas* of the *madhyama-adhikārī* level to deal with one another by offering "obeisances."

"Constantly" (*nirantara*): *antara* means "interval," and *nirantara* is that in which there is no interval. The interval, or obstruction, is the absence of activity of the conscious faculty (*cetana-vṛtti*) in the form of other desires (*anyābhilāṣa*), *karma*, *jñāna* and laxity (*śaithilya*) — that is, inertness (*jāḍya*). As Śrī Rūpa Prabhu says: "The highest devotion is the cultivation of service to Kṛṣṇa in a favorable spirit, free from other desires and not covered by *jñāna*, *karma* and the like." (*Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu*, Pūrva-vibhāga, first *laharī*) Or else, by the word *antara* are meant: "the body" (*deha*), that is, sense gratification; "wealth" (*draviṇa*), the endeavor to amass money impurely; "people" (*janatā*), the company of the unworthy, that is, bad company; "greed" (*lobha*), greed of the tongue, or covetousness; and godlessness (*pāṣaṇḍatā*). Godlessness is to regard the form of Viṣṇu as "matter" — stone, wood, gold, brass and so on; the guru as a "mortal"; the Vaiṣṇava as belonging to a "caste" or as "earthly"; the water that has washed the feet of Viṣṇu and the Vaiṣṇava as ordinary "water"; the name and *mantra* of Viṣṇu, or the name given by the genuine guru, as "sound like any worldly sound." Godlessness is also to place Viṣṇu, the Lord of all lords, or Śrī Kṛṣṇa — the original form (*svayaṁ-rūpa*), the Truth higher than Viṣṇu — and Their own potencies on a level with the other gods, who depend on the three modes. In the end it is the endeavor to realize the self, the conscious, by relying on the non-self, the inert, or to derive it from the inert; it is the knowledge that places the transcendental Reality on a level with worldly, partial things measurable by the senses; or, in other words, to regard Śrī Hari, guru and Vaiṣṇava with a dualistic mind as "others." All this gives rise to offenses. Śrī Jīva Prabhu says in the *Bhakti-sandarbha* (*anuccheda* 265): "In the verse 'He on whose tongue there is even one name, in whose memory it is…' and so on, the ten offenses are indicated by the word *pāṣaṇḍa* connected with body, wealth and the like, for they all are godlessness." Further: "One who has love (*prema*) for the Lord, friendship for those dependent on Him, mercy for the ignorant and indifference toward the hostile is a *madhyama* (an intermediate devotee)." (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.2.46) And in the instructions to Sanātana (Madhya 22): "One who has faith is qualified for devotion. According to faith, devotees are 'highest,' 'intermediate' and 'junior.' <…> One who does not know the reasoning of the

scriptures well but whose faith is firm is a ‘*madhyama-adhikārī*,’ most fortunate. <…> Devotees are ranked higher and higher according to the degree of their *rati* and *prema*.” (*Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Madhya 22.64, 66, 68)

In the intermediate *bhāgavata*, love (*prīti*) for Śrī Nāma grows. Therefore, worshiping Śrī Nāma constantly with the highest love in the sacrifice of *kīrtana*, he directs his *prema* to Bhagavān. Constantly filled with love for the transcendental Śrī Nāma and engaged in its cultivation, he can understand himself as a “transcendental servant of Kṛṣṇa” (*kṛṣṇa-dāsa*). Moreover, at times he shows mercy to a devotee whose taste for Śrī Nāma is comparatively small, explaining to him his transcendental nature (*svarūpa*). But the hostile person, wholly devoid of love for the pure devotee and for Bhagavān, he regards as “devoid of realization of Kṛṣṇa's transcendental nature, with his conscious faculty covered, entirely worldly,” and gives up his company. The intermediate *adhikārī* can also understand the components, that is, the paraphernalia, of pure devotion as “transcendental.”

Later they again ask the marks of a Vaiṣṇava; the Lord's answer —

বর্ষান্তরে পুনঃ তাঁরা ঐছে প্রশ্ন কৈল ।
‘বৈষ্ণবের তারতম্য’ প্রভু শিখাইল ॥ ৭৩ ॥

varṣāntare punaḥ tāṁrā aiche praśna kaila
after a year again they such a question asked
‘vaiṣṇavera tāratamya’ prabhu śikhāila
of the Vaiṣṇavas the gradation the Lord taught

73 A year later they asked the same question again, and the Lord taught them the gradation of Vaiṣṇavas:

*The Lord indicates the marks of the *uttama-adhikārī*, or *mahā-bhāgavata* —*

যাঁহার দর্শনে মুখে আইসে কৃষ্ণনাম ।
তাঁহারে জানিহ তুমি ‘বৈষ্ণব-প্রধান’ ॥ ৭৪ ॥

yāṁhāra darśane mukhe āise kṛṣṇa-nāma
whose at the sight to the mouth comes the name of Kṛṣṇa
tāṁhāre jāniha tumi 'vaiṣṇava-pradhāna'
him know you the foremost Vaiṣṇava

74 "One whose very sight brings the name of Kṛṣṇa to the lips — know him to be the foremost Vaiṣṇava."

Anubhāṣya.

Know the Vaiṣṇava at whose sight the name of Kṛṣṇa comes naturally to the viewer's lips to be a *mahā-bhāgavata*, perfect in his very nature (*svarūpa-siddha*). The activity of his consciousness is fully awakened, kindled, uncovered; in other words, he is wholly engaged in serving Kṛṣṇa in pure, unmixed *prema*. Therefore he always remains in the waking state. Endowed with knowledge and realization of Bhagavān (*jñāna* and *vijñāna*), he sees Kṛṣṇa, or what belongs to Kṛṣṇa, everywhere; from his holy mouth the pure name of Śrī Kṛṣṇa constantly and beautifully resounds. Himself possessed of divine vision, he is able to open the closed eyes of ignorance of other *jīvas* who sleep the sleep of delusion — forgetfulness of Kṛṣṇa, that is, aversion to Kṛṣṇa. In other words, he can free them from inertness, give them divine vision, awaken the activity of their consciousness and engage them forever in the service of Kṛṣṇa and of what belongs to Kṛṣṇa. Sayings such as "Each of them holds the power to deliver the universe" and "Until a touchstone turns iron into gold by its touch, no one can recognise it as a touchstone" (*Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Madhya 6.279) are spoken of just such devotees. Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī writes in the *Upadeśāmṛta*: "And one who is expert in *bhajana*, exclusively devoted, and whose heart is free from blaming others and the like should be honored with service, for his company is the gain one longs for." He follows completely the verse *tṛṇād api sunīcena*, spoken by the Lord's holy mouth. According to Madhya 9.36–37, he is Kṛṣṇa in the form of the shelter (*āśraya*), that is, a *mahā-bhāgavata*; he alone performs pure Hari-*kīrtana*. Therefore the intermediate *bhāgavata* should always long to hear from just such a person — one who does not see high and low in the material world, whose heart is free from blaming others — and satisfy him by every kind of service. Then at last, by the power of his mercy, that *madhyama-adhikārī* will gain the good fortune to become an *uttama-adhikārī*. "He who sees in all beings the love for Bhagavān that lives in his own soul, and sees all beings in Bhagavān, the Soul of all, is the best of *bhāgavatas*." (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.2.45) In the instructions to Sanātana (Madhya 22): "One who has faith is qualified for devotion.

According to faith, devotees are ‘highest,’ ‘intermediate’ and ‘junior.’ One who is expert in the reasoning of the scriptures and whose faith is firm is an ‘*uttama-adhikārī*’; he delivers the world.” (*Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Madhya 22.64–65) Toward the three realities — “Bhagavān,” “devotion” and “the devotee” — the *mahā-bhāgavata* has a transcendental, unrestricted vision full of *prema*; apart from this he has no other vision: “he knows only this: everyone worships Kṛṣṇa.” Therefore he is one whom Kṛṣṇa Himself has accepted as His own.

*The Lord indicates the marks of the Vaiṣṇava on three levels (*adhikāra*) —*

ক্রম করি’ কহে প্রভু ‘বৈষ্ণব’-লক্ষণ ।
‘বৈষ্ণব’, ‘বৈষ্ণবতর’, আর ‘বৈষ্ণবতম’ ॥ ৭৫ ॥

krama kari’ kahe prabhu ‘vaiṣṇava’-lakṣaṇa
in order making speaks the Lord of a Vaiṣṇava the marks
‘vaiṣṇava’, ‘vaiṣṇavatara’, āra ‘vaiṣṇavatama’
Vaiṣṇava a higher Vaiṣṇava and the highest Vaiṣṇava

75 Step by step the Lord described the marks of a Vaiṣṇava: the Vaiṣṇava, the higher Vaiṣṇava (*vaiṣṇavatara*) and the highest Vaiṣṇava (*vaiṣṇavatama*).

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The residents of Kulīnagrāma had heard the answer to their question the year before: “Anyone from whose mouth I hear the name of Kṛṣṇa even once,” and so on. Yet this time they asked the same question again, and the Lord said, “Know the one from whose mouth you hear the name of Kṛṣṇa constantly to be the best of Vaiṣṇavas, and serve his feet constantly.” The next year the residents of Kulīnagrāma asked the very same question, and this time the Lord answered, “Know the one at whose mere sight the name of Kṛṣṇa comes naturally to the viewer's mouth to be the foremost Vaiṣṇava.” If we consider these three answers given in three years, the Lord's words yield the marks of three kinds of Vaiṣṇavas: the *vaiṣṇava*, the *vaiṣṇavatara* (the better Vaiṣṇava) and the *vaiṣṇavatama* (the best Vaiṣṇava). To serve all three kinds of Vaiṣṇavas is the duty of a Vaiṣṇava householder. The purport of the Lord's words is this: one who has merely received Vaiṣṇava initiation but has never once chanted the name of Kṛṣṇa without offense is not to be served as a Vaiṣṇava; he need only be honored as a “well-wisher” and a “guest.”

All but Puṇḍarīka return to Gauḍa —

এইমত সব বৈষ্ণব গৌড়ে চলিলা ।
বিদ্যানিধি সে বৎসর নীলাদ্রি রহিলা ॥ ৭৬ ॥

ei mata saba vaiṣṇava gauḍe calilā
in this way all the Vaiṣṇavas to Gauḍa went
vidyānidhi se vatsara nīlādri rahilā
Vidyānidhi that year in Nīlādri stayed

76 In this way all the Vaiṣṇavas returned to Gauḍa. That year Vidyānidhi stayed on in Nīlādri.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Vidyānidhi is Puṇḍarīka Vidyānidhi.

The friendship of Puṇḍarīka and Svarūpa —

স্বরূপ-সহিত তাঁর হয় সখ্য-প্রীতি ।
দুই-জনায় কৃষ্ণ-কথায় একত্রই স্থিতি ॥ ৭৭ ॥

svarūpa-sahita tāṁra haya sakhya-prīti
with Svarūpa his is friendly affection
dui-janāya kṛṣṇa-kathāya ekatrai sthiti
of the two in talks of Kṛṣṇa together the abiding

77 He had a loving friendship with Svarūpa, and the two of them stayed together, absorbed in talks about Kṛṣṇa.

*Prema-nidhi again gives the *mantra* to Gadādhara and sees the Oḍana-ṣaṣṭhī —*

গদাধর-পণ্ডিতে তিঁহো পুনঃ মন্ত্র দিল ।
ওড়ন-ষষ্ঠীর দিনে যাত্রা যে দেখিল ॥ ৭৮ ॥

gadādhara-paṇḍite tiṁho punaḥ mantra dila
to Gadādhara Paṇḍita he again mantra gave
oḍana-ṣaṣṭhīra dine yātrā ye dekhila
of Oḍana-ṣaṣṭhī on the day the festival which he saw

78 He gave the *mantra* to Gadādhara Paṇḍita a second time, and he saw the festival on the day of Oḍana-ṣaṣṭhī.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Oḍana-ṣaṣṭhī. The first *ṣaṣṭhī* after the onset of the cold season is called Oḍana-ṣaṣṭhī. On that day warm cloth is put on the body of Jagannāthadeva. This warm cloth is *māṛuyā*, that is, a weaver's unwashed cloth with starch (*māṛ*) in it. Because the Deity was given a starched cloth, Puṇḍarīka Vidyānidhi "found fault" a little on this account and showed some disdain for the devotees of Utkala. Therefore he received what he deserved.

Anubhāṣya.

See the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya-khaṇḍa, chapter 11.

The story of Puṇḍarīka and Jagannātha's starched cloth —

জগন্নাথ পরেন তথা 'মাড়ুয়া' বসন ।
দেখিয়া সঘৃণ হৈল বিদ্যানিধির মন ॥ ৭৯ ॥

jagannātha parena tathā 'māḍuyā' vasana
Jagannātha wears there starched cloth
dekhiyā saghṛṇa haila vidyānidhira mana
seeing disgusted became Vidyānidhi's mind

79 There Jagannātha is dressed in starched (*māḍuyā*) cloth, and when Vidyānidhi saw this, he felt disgust.

সেই রাত্র্যে জগন্নাথ-বলাই আসিয়া ।
দুই-ভাই চড়া'ন তাঁরে হাসিয়া হাসিয়া ॥ ৮০ ॥

sei rātrye jagannātha-balāi āsiyā
that night Jagannātha and Balāi coming
dui-bhāi caḍā'na tāṁre hāsiyā hāsiyā
the two brothers slap him laughing laughing

80 That night Jagannātha and Balāi came to him, and the two brothers slapped him, laughing all the while.

*This is described in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata* —*

গাল ফুলিল, আচার্য্য অন্তরে উল্লাস ।
বিস্তারি' বর্ণিয়াছেন বৃন্দাবন-দাস ॥ ৮১ ॥

gāla phulila, ācārya antare ullāsa
the cheeks swelled the Ācārya's in the heart joy
vistāri' varṇiyāchena vṛndāvana dāsa
in detail has described Vṛndāvana dāsa

81 His cheeks swelled, but the Ācārya (Vidyānidhi) rejoiced at heart. Vṛndāvana dāsa has described this in detail.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

See the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya-khaṇḍa, chapters 10 and 11.

Anubhāṣya.

Balāi is Śrī Balarāma; *ācārya* is Ācāryanidhi.[11]

Every year the Gauḍīya devotees come and see the festivals and so on —

এইমত প্রত্যব্দ আইসে গৌড়ের ভক্তগণ ।
প্রভু-সঙ্গে রহি' করে যাত্রা-দরশন ॥ ৮২ ॥

ei mata pratyabda āise gauḍera bhakta-gaṇa
in this way every year come of Gauḍa the devotees
prabhu-saṅge rahi' kare yātrā-daraśana
with the Lord staying do of the festival seeing

82 In this way the devotees of Gauḍa came every year, stayed with the Lord and saw the festival.

The author promises to describe the special events of those years —

তার মধ্যে যে যে বর্ষে আছয়ে বিশেষ ।
বিস্তারিয়া আগে তাহা কহিব নিঃশেষ ॥ ৮৩ ॥

tāra madhye ye ye varṣe āchaye viśeṣa
that among in which which years there is something special
vistāriyā āge tāhā kahiba niḥśeṣa
in detail later that I shall tell fully

83 Whatever was special in particular years, I shall relate fully and in detail later on.

Four years of pastimes in Nīlācala with the devotees, two years for the journey south and back —

এইমত মহাপ্রভুর চারি বৎসর গেল ।
দক্ষিণ যাঞা আসিতে দুই বৎসর লাগিল ॥ ৮৪ ॥

ei mata mahāprabhura cāri vatsara gela
in this way of Mahāprabhu four years passed
dakṣiṇa yāñā āsite dui vatsara lāgila
to the south going to come back two years it took

84 So four years of Mahāprabhu's life passed. Going south and coming back took two years.

For two more years the Lord wishes to go to Vṛndāvana, but Rāya's efforts hold Him back —

আর দুই বৎসর চাহে বৃন্দাবন যাইতে ।
রামানন্দ-হঠে প্রভু না পারে চলিতে ॥ ৮৫ ॥

āra dui vatsara cāhe vṛndāvana yāite
another two years He wants to Vṛndāvana to go
rāmānanda-haṭhe prabhu nā pāre calite
through Rāmānanda's insistence the Lord not can set out

85 For another two years He wanted to go to Vṛndāvana, but because of Rāmānanda's insistence the Lord could not set out.

Anubhāṣya.
Haṭha means the use of force, compulsion.

In the fifth year the Gauḍīya devotees see the chariot festival and return to Gauḍa —

পঞ্চম বৎসরে গৌড়ের ভক্তগণ আইলা ।
রথ দেখি' না রহিলা, গৌড়েরে চলিলা ॥ ৮৬ ॥

pañcama vatsare gauḍera bhakta-gaṇa āilā
in the fifth year of Gauḍa the devotees came
ratha dekhi' nā rahilā, gauḍere calilā
the chariot seeing not stayed to Gauḍa went

86 In the fifth year the devotees of Gauḍa came; they saw the Ratha-yātrā, but they did not stay and returned to Gauḍa.

The Lord asks the Bhaṭṭācārya and Rāya for consent to go to Vṛndāvana by way of Gauḍa —

তবে প্রভু সার্ব্বভৌম-রামানন্দ-স্থানে ।
আলিঙ্গন করি' কহে মধুর-বচনে ॥ ৮৭ ॥

tabe prabhu sārvabhauma-rāmānanda-sthāne
then the Lord to Sārvabhauma and Rāmānanda
āliṅgana kari' kahe madhura-vacane
embrace making speaks with sweet words

87 Then the Lord embraced Sārvabhauma and Rāmānanda and spoke to them sweetly:

বহুত উৎকণ্ঠা মোর যাইতে বৃন্দাবন ।
তোমার হঠে দুই বৎসর না কৈলুঁ গমন ॥ ৮৮ ॥

bahuta utkaṇṭhā mora yāite vṛndāvana
great eagerness Mine to go to Vṛndāvana
tomāra haṭhe dui vatsara nā kailuṁ gamana
your through insistence two years not I made departure

88 "I long very much to go to Vṛndāvana, but because of your insistence I have not gone for two years.

অবশ্য চলিব, দুঁহে করহ সম্মতি ।
তোমা-দুঁহা বিনা মোর নাহি অন্য গতি ॥ ৮৯ ॥

avaśya caliba, duṁhe karaha sammati
certainly I shall go both give consent
tomā-duṁhā vinā mora nāhi anya gati
you two without Mine there is no other refuge

89 I shall certainly go now; please, both of you, give your consent. I have no refuge but you two.

The Lord's two objects of reverence in Gauḍa: (1) Śacīdevī and (2) Gaṅgā-devī

—

গৌড়-দেশে হয় মোর 'দুই সমাশ্রয়' ।
'জননী' 'জাহ্নবী', — এই দুই দয়াময় ॥ ৯০ ॥

gauḍa-deśe haya mora 'dui samāśraya'
in Gauḍa-deśa are Mine two shelters
'jananī' 'jāhnavī', — ei dui dayāmaya
mother Jāhnavī — these two all-merciful

90 In Gauḍa-deśa I have two shelters, My mother and the Jāhnavī (Gaṅgā); both are all-merciful.

গৌড়-দেশ দিয়া যাব তাঁ-সবা দেখিয়া ।
তুমি দুঁহে আজ্ঞা দেহ' পরসন্ন হঞা ॥ ৯১ ॥

gauḍa-deśa diyā yāba tāṁ-sabā dekhiyā
through Gauḍa-deśa I shall go them seeing
tumi duṁhe ājñā deha' parasanna hañā
you both permission give pleased becoming

91 I shall go by way of Gauḍa-deśa and see them both. Be pleased, both of you, and give Me leave."

The Bhaṭṭācārya and Rāya consent, but because of the rains ask Him to wait until Vijayā-daśamī —

শুনিয়া প্রভুর বাণী মনে বিচারয় ।
প্রভু-সনে অতি হঠ কভু ভাল নয় ॥ ৯২ ॥

śuniyā prabhura vāṇī mane vicāraya
hearing of the Lord the words in the mind they consider
prabhu-sane ati haṭha kabhu bhāla naya
with the Lord too much insistence ever good not is

92 Hearing the Lord's words, they reflected, "To press the Lord too hard is never good."

দুঁহে কহে, — এবে বর্ষা, চলিতে নারিবা ।
বিজয়া-দশমী আইলে অবশ্য চলিবা ॥ ৯৩ ॥

duṁhe kahe, — ebe varṣā, calite nāribā
both say — now the rains to travel You will not be able
vijayā-daśamī āile avaśya calibā
Vijayā-daśamī when it comes certainly You will go

93 They both said, "Now it is the rainy season; You cannot travel. When Vijayā-daśamī comes, You will certainly go."

The Lord waits out the rains and on the day of Vijayā-daśamī sets out for Vṛndāvana —

আনন্দে মহাপ্রভু বর্ষা কৈল সমাধান ।
বিজয়া-দশমী-দিনে করিল পয়ান ॥ ৯৪ ॥

ānande mahāprabhu varṣā kaila samādhāna
in joy Mahāprabhu the rainy season made completion
vijayā-daśamī-dine karila payāna
on the day of Vijayā-daśamī made departure

94 Mahāprabhu happily saw the rainy season through, and on the day of Vijayā-daśamī He set out.

Anubhāṣya.

Payāna means *prayāṇa*, setting out on a journey.

*The Lord takes along Jagannātha's *prasāda* and other things —*

জগন্নাথের প্রসাদ প্রভু যত পাঞাছিল ।
কড়ার চন্দন, ডোর, সব সঙ্গে লৈল ॥ ৯৫ ॥

jagannāthera prasāda prabhu yata pāñāchila
of Jagannātha the prasāda the Lord as much as had received
kaḍāra candana, ḍora, saba saṅge laila
kaḍāra sandalwood ropes all with He took

95 He took with Him all the *prasāda* of Jagannātha that He had received — *kaḍāra* ointment, sandalwood paste and ropes.

Anubhāṣya.

Kaṛāra: of a tawny color; an ointment (?); *ḍora*: a rope.

The Lord sets out in the morning; the devotees of Purī follow Him —

জগন্নাথে আজ্ঞা মাগি' প্রভাতে চলিলা ।
ওড়িয়া ভক্তগণ সঙ্গে পাছে চলি' আইলা ॥ ৯৬ ॥

jagannāthe ājñā māgi' prabhāte calilā
from Jagannātha permission begging at dawn He set out
oḍiyā bhakta-gaṇa saṅge pāche cali' āilā
the Oḍiyā devotees together behind going came

96 He begged leave of Jagannātha and set out at dawn, and the Oḍiyā devotees came following behind Him.

Stopping the devotees of Purī, the Lord comes with His associates to Bhavānīpura —

ওড়িয়া-ভক্তগণে প্রভু যত্নে নিবারিলা ।
নিজগণ সঙ্গে প্রভু 'ভবানীপুর' আইলা ॥ ৯৭ ॥

oḍiyā-bhakta-gaṇe prabhu yatne nivārilā
the Oḍiyā devotees the Lord with effort stopped
nija-gaṇa saṅge prabhu 'bhavānīpura' āilā
His own associates with the Lord to Bhavānīpura came

97 With some effort the Lord made the Oḍiyā devotees turn back, and with His own associates He came to Bhavānīpura.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Bhavānīpura is Jānakādeipura; that is, "Bhavānīpura" lies before Jānakīdevīpura.

*Rāya comes after Him; Vāṇīnātha sends *prasāda* —*

রামানন্দ আইলা পাছে দোলায় চড়িয়া ।
বাণীনাথ বহু প্রসাদ দিল পাঠাঞা ॥ ৯৮ ॥

rāmānanda āilā pāche dolāya caḍiyā
Rāmānanda came behind in a palanquin riding
vāṇīnātha bahu prasāda dila pāṭhāñā
Vāṇīnātha much prasāda gave sending

98 Rāmānanda came after Him, riding in a palanquin, and Vāṇīnātha sent a great deal of *prasāda*.

A night's stay there; in the morning the Lord comes to Bhuvaneśvara —

প্রসাদ ভোজন করি' তথায় রহিলা ।
প্রাতঃকালে চলি' প্রভু 'ভুবনেশ্বর' আইলা ॥ ৯৯ ॥

prasāda bhojana kari' tathāya rahilā
prasāda eating having done there He stayed
prātaḥ-kāle cali' prabhu 'bhuvaneśvara' āilā
in the morning going the Lord to Bhuvaneśvara came

99 After taking the *prasāda* He stayed there, and setting out in the morning, the Lord came to Bhuvaneśvara.

From there the Lord comes to Kaṭaka and sees Sākṣi-gopāla —

‘কটকে’ আসিয়া কৈল ‘গোপাল’ দরশন ।
স্বপ্নেশ্বর-বিপ্র কৈল প্রভুর নিমন্ত্রণ ॥ ১০০ ॥

‘kaṭake’ āsiyā kaila ‘gopāla’ daraśana
to Kaṭaka coming He made of Gopāla darśana
svapneśvara-vipra kaila prabhura nimantraṇa
the brāhmaṇa Svapneśvara made of the Lord invitation

100 Coming to Kaṭaka, He had *darśana* of Gopāla, and the brāhmaṇa Svapneśvara invited the Lord for a meal.

Rāya invites the Lord's devotees; the Lord stays in a garden —

রামানন্দ-রায় সব-গণে নিমন্ত্রিল ।
বাহির উদ্যানে আসি, প্রভু বাসা কৈল ॥ ১০১ ॥

rāmānanda-rāya saba-gaṇe nimantrila
Rāmānanda Rāya all the associates invited
bāhira udyāne āsi, prabhu vāsā kaila
in an outer garden coming the Lord residence made

101 Rāmānanda Rāya invited all the associates, and the Lord came to a garden outside the town and stayed there.

While the Lord rests under a tree, Rāya informs Pratāparudra —

ভিক্ষা করি’ বকুল-তলে করিলা বিশ্রাম ।
প্রতাপরুদ্র-ঠাঞি রায় করিল পয়ান ॥ ১০২ ॥

bhikṣā kari’ bakula-tale karilā viśrāma
the meal having taken under a bakula tree made rest
pratāparudra-ṭhāñi rāya karila payāna
to Pratāparudra Rāya made departure

102 After His meal He rested under a *bakula* tree, and Rāmānanda Rāya went to Pratāparudra.

The king comes at once, bows down to the Lord and offers prayers —

শুনি' আনন্দিত রাজা অতিশীঘ্র আইলা ।
প্রভু দেখি' দণ্ডবৎ ভূমেতে পড়িলা ॥ ১০৩ ॥

śuni' ānandita rājā ati-śīghra āilā
hearing delighted the king very quickly came
prabhu dekhi' daṇḍavat bhūmete paḍilā
the Lord seeing like a rod on the ground fell

103 Delighted at the news, the king came at once, and seeing the Lord, he fell flat on the ground like a rod.

পুনঃ উঠে, পুনঃ পড়ে প্রণয়-বিহ্বল ।
স্তুতি করে, পুলকাঙ্গ, পড়ে অশ্রুজল ॥ ১০৪ ॥

punaḥ uṭhe, punaḥ paḍe praṇaya-vihvala
again he rises again he falls overwhelmed by love
stuti kare, pulakāṅga, paḍe aśru-jala
prayers he offers with hair standing on end fall tears

104 Overwhelmed by love, he rose and fell again and again; he offered prayers, the hair of his body stood on end, and tears flowed from his eyes.

Seeing the king's pure devotion, the Lord embraces him —

তাঁর ভক্তি দেখি' প্রভুর তুষ্ট হৈল মন ।
উঠি' মহাপ্রভু তাঁরে কৈলা আলিঙ্গন ॥ ১০৫ ॥

tāṁra bhakti dekhi' prabhura tuṣṭa haila mana
his devotion seeing of the Lord pleased became the mind
uṭhi' mahāprabhu tāṁre kailā āliṅgana
rising Mahāprabhu him made embrace

105 Seeing his devotion, the Lord was pleased at heart. Mahāprabhu rose and embraced him.

পুনঃ স্তুতি করি' রাজা করয়ে প্রণাম ।
প্রভু-কৃপা-অশ্রুতে তাঁর দেহ হৈল স্নান ॥ ১০৬ ॥

punaḥ stuti kari' rājā karaye praṇāma
again prayers offering the king makes obeisance
prabhu-kṛpā-aśrute tāṁra deha haila snāna
in the tears of the Lord's mercy his body became bathed

106 Again the king offered prayers and bowed down, and his body was bathed in tears of the Lord's mercy.

Anubhāṣya.
Snāna here means bathed.

Rāya consoles the king; the Lord is merciful to him without pretense —

সুস্থ করি, রামানন্দ রাজারে বসাইলা ।
কায়মনোবাক্যে প্রভু তাঁরে কৃপা কৈলা ॥ ১০৭ ॥

sustha kari, rāmānanda rājāre vasāilā
calm making Rāmānanda the king seated
kāya-mano-vākye prabhu tāṁre kṛpā kailā
in body, mind and words the Lord to him mercy showed

107 Rāmānanda calmed the king and seated him, and the Lord showed him mercy in body, mind and words.

From then on the Lord's name is "Pratāparudra-saṁtrātā" (the Savior of Pratāparudra) —

ঐছে তাঁহারে কৃপা কৈল গৌররায় ।
'প্রতাপরুদ্র-সংত্রাতা' নাম হৈল যায় ॥ ১০৮ ॥

aiche tāṁhāre kṛpā kaila gaurarāya
such to him mercy showed Gaurarāya
'pratāparudra-saṁtrātā' nāma haila yāya
the Saviour of Pratāparudra the name became by which

108 Gaurarāya showed him such mercy that He came to be called “the Saviour of Pratāparudra.”

Anubhāṣya.
Yāya means “by which,” “for which reason.”

The retinue bows to the Lord; the king takes leave of the Lord —

রাজ-পাত্রগণ কৈল প্রভুর বন্দন ।
রাজারে বিদায় দিলা শচীর নন্দন ॥ ১০৯ ॥

rāja-pātra-gaṇa kaila prabhura vandana
the royal ministers made of the Lord homage
rājāre vidāya dilā śacīra nandana
to the king leave gave of Śacī the son

109 The king’s ministers paid homage to the Lord, and Śacī’s son gave the king leave to go.

The king circulates an edict throughout his kingdom —

বাহিরে আসি’ রাজা আজ্ঞা-পত্র লেখাইল ।
নিজ-রাজ্যে যত ‘বিষয়ী’, তাহারে পাঠাইল ॥ ১১০ ॥

bāhire āsi’ rājā ājñā-patra lekhāila
outside coming the king a written order had written
nija-rājye yata ‘viṣayī’, tāhāre pāṭhāila
in his own kingdom as many revenue officers to them sent

110 Coming outside, the king had an order drawn up and sent it to all the revenue officers (*viṣayī*) of his kingdom:

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
A *viṣayī* is a royal officer who collects the revenue of the villages.

‘গ্রামে-গ্রামে’ নূতন আবাস করিবা ।
পাঁচ-সাত গৃহ, সব সামগ্রে ভরিবা ॥ ১১১ ॥

‘grāme-grāme’ nūtana āvāsa karibā
in village after village new lodgings you shall make
pāṁca-sāta gṛha, saba sāmagrye bharibā
five or seven houses with all provisions you shall fill

111 “In every village build new lodgings; fill five or seven houses with all provisions.

আপনি প্রভুকে লঞা তাঁহা উত্তরিবা ।
রাত্রি-দিবা বেত্রহস্তে সেবায় রহিবা ॥ ১১২ ॥

āpani prabhuke laña tāṁhā uttaribā
yourselves the Lord taking there you shall lodge
rātri-dibā vetra-haste sevāya rahibā
night and day cane in hand in service you shall remain

112 Escort the Lord there yourselves and lodge Him, and stay in His service night and day, cane in hand.”

*The order to the two *mahāpātras* —*

দুই মহাপাত্র, — ‘হরিচন্দন’, ‘মঙ্গরাজ’ ।
তাঁরে আজ্ঞা দিল রাজা — করিহ সর্ব্ব কাজ ॥ ১১৩ ॥

dui mahā-pātra, — ‘haricandana’, ‘maṅgarāja’
two great ministers — Haricandana Maṅgarāja
tāṁre ājñā dila rājā — kariha sarva kāja
to them order gave the king — do every task

113 The king gave this order to two of his chief ministers, Haricandana and Maṅgarāja: “See to everything.

Anubhāṣya.
Maṅgarāja: “Mardarāja” (?).

এক নব্য-নৌকা আনি’ রাখহ নদী-তীরে ।
যাঁহা স্নান করি’ প্রভু যা’ন নদী-পারে ॥ ১১৪ ॥

eka navya-naukā āni' rākhaha nadī-tīre
one new boat bringing keep on the river bank
yāṁhā snāna kari' prabhu yā'na nadī-pāre
where bath having taken the Lord goes across the river

114 Bring a new boat and keep it at the river bank where the Lord will bathe and cross the river.

The king's deep love for Gaura —

তাঁহা স্তম্ভ রোপণ কর 'মহাতীর্থ' করি' ।
নিত্য স্নান করিহ তাঁহা, তাঁহা যেন মরি ॥ ১১৫ ॥

tāṁhā stambha ropaṇa kara 'mahā-tīrtha' kari'
there a pillar erecting do a great tīrtha making
nitya snāna kariha tāṁhā, tāṁhā yena mari
daily bath take there there may I die

115 Erect a pillar there and make it a great *tīrtha*. Bathe there every day — and may I leave my body there.[5]

The king asks Rāmānanda to go to the Lord —

চতুর্দ্বারে করহ উত্তম নব্য বাস ।
রামানন্দ, যাহ তুমি মহাপ্রভু-পাশ ॥ ১১৬ ॥

caturdvāre karaha uttama navya vāsa
in Caturdvāra build excellent new lodgings
rāmānanda, yāha tumi mahāprabhu-pāśa
Rāmānanda go you to Mahāprabhu's side

116 Build excellent new lodgings in Caturdvāra. And you, Rāmānanda, go to Mahāprabhu."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Caturdvāra. From Kaṭaka, after crossing the Mahānadī, one comes to the village of Caturdvāra; it is commonly called "Caudār."

Anubhāṣya.

Navya-vāsa means a new house fit to live in.

In the evening the queens watch the Lord pass by —

সন্ধ্যাতে চলিবে প্রভু, — নৃপতি শুনিল ।
হস্তী-উপর তাম্বুগৃহে স্ত্রীগণে চড়াইল ॥ ১১৭ ॥

sandhyāte calibe prabhu, — nṛpati śunila
in the evening will set out the Lord — the king heard
hastī-upara tāmbu-gṛhe strī-gaṇe caḍāila
on elephants in tents the women he seated

117 The king heard that the Lord would set out in the evening, and he had the royal ladies seated in tents on the backs of elephants.

In the evening the Lord leaves Kaṭaka —

প্রভুর চলিবার পথে রহে সারি হঞা ।
সন্ধ্যাতে চলিলা প্রভু নিজগণ লঞা ॥ ১১৮ ॥

prabhura calibāra pathe rahe sāri hañā
of the Lord of the going on the road they stay in a row forming
sandhyāte calilā prabhu nija-gaṇa lañā
in the evening set out the Lord His own associates taking

118 They stood in a row along the road the Lord was to take, and in the evening the Lord set out with His associates.

Bathing in the Mahānadī; the queens' obeisances —

'চিত্রোৎপলা-নদী' আসি' ঘাটে কৈল স্নান ।
মহিষীসকল দেখে, করয়ে প্রণাম ॥ ১১৯ ॥

'citrotpalā-nadī' āsi' ghāṭe kaila snāna
to the river Citrotpalā coming at the ghāṭ made bath
mahiṣī-sakala dekhe, karaye praṇāma
the queens all see make obeisance

119 Coming to the river Citrotpalā, He bathed at the *ghāṭ*, and all the queens watched Him and bowed down.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The river Citrotpalā. The place where one comes out from Kaṭaka to the Mahānadī is called "the river Citrotpalā." The *paṇḍitas* of Utkala, citing some *tantra*, say: "In the Kali age the Citrotpalā is the Gaṅgā."

On seeing the Lord, all are overwhelmed with divine emotion —

প্রভুর দরশনে সবে হৈল প্রেমময়।
'কৃষ্ণ' 'কৃষ্ণ' কহে, নেত্র অশ্রু বরিষয় ॥ ১২০ ॥

prabhura daraśane sabe haila premamaya
of the Lord at the sight all became full of love
'kṛṣṇa' 'kṛṣṇa' kahe, netra aśru variṣaya
Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa they say the eyes tears shower

120 At the sight of the Lord they were all filled with love; they cried "Kṛṣṇa! Kṛṣṇa!" and tears streamed from their eyes.

The wondrous embodiment of compassion —

এমন কৃপালু নাহি শুনি ত্রিভুবনে।
কৃষ্ণপ্রেমা হয় যাঁর দূর দরশনে ॥ ১২১ ॥

emana kṛpālu nāhi śuni tribhuvane
such merciful not I hear in the three worlds
kṛṣṇa-premā haya yāṁra dūra daraśane
love for Kṛṣṇa arises whose from afar at the sight

121 Nowhere in the three worlds have I heard of one so merciful: love for Kṛṣṇa awakens even in those who see Him from afar.

Having crossed the river and come to Caturdvāra, the Lord partakes of

*Jagannātha's *prasāda*, sent every day by the *paḍichā* —*

নৌকাতে চড়িয়া প্রভু হৈল নদী পার ।
জ্যোৎস্নাবতী রাত্র্যে চলি' আইলা চতুর্দ্বার ॥ ১২২ ॥

naukāte caḍiyā prabhu haila nadī pāra
into the boat climbing the Lord became of the river across
jyotsnāvatī rātrye cali' āilā caturdvāra
on a moonlit night going came to Caturdvāra

122 The Lord boarded the boat and crossed the river, and travelling on through the moonlit night He came to Caturdvāra.

রাত্র্যে তথা রহি' প্রাতে স্নানকৃত্য কৈল ।
হেনকালে জগন্নাথের মহাপ্রসাদ আইল ॥ ১২৩ ॥

rātrye tathā rahi' prāte snāna-kṛtya kaila
at night there staying in the morning bathing made
hena-kāle jagannāthera mahā-prasāda āila
at that time of Jagannātha mahā-prasāda came

123 He stayed there that night and bathed in the morning. Just then Jagannātha's *mahā-prasāda* arrived.

রাজার আজ্ঞায় পড়িছা পাঠায় দিনে দিনে ।
বহুত প্রসাদ পাঠায় দিয়া বহু-জনে ॥ ১২৪ ॥

rājāra ājñāya paḍichā pāṭhāya dine dine
of the king by the order the paḍichā sends day by day
bahuta prasāda pāṭhāya diyā bahu-jane
abundant prasāda sends by many people

124 By the king's order the *paḍichā* sent *prasāda* day after day — a great quantity of it, carried by many people.

স্বগণ-সহিতে প্রভু প্রসাদ অঙ্গীকরি' ।
উঠিয়া চলিলা প্রভু বলি' 'হরি' 'হরি' ॥ ১২৫ ॥

sva-gaṇa-sahite prabhu prasāda aṅgīkari'
with His own associates the Lord prasāda accepting
uṭhiyā calilā prabhu bali' 'hari' 'hari'
rising set out the Lord saying Hari Hari

125 The Lord accepted the *prasāda* with His associates, then rose and set out, calling "Hari! Hari!"

Three royal officers, headed by Rāya, go with the Lord —

রামানন্দ, মঙ্গরাজ, শ্রীহরিচন্দন ।
সঙ্গে সেবা করি' চলে এই তিন জন ॥ ১২৬ ॥

rāmānanda, maṅgarāja, śrī-haricandana
Rāmānanda Maṅgarāja Śrī Haricandana
saṅge sevā kari' cale ei tina jana
together service doing go these three persons

126 Rāmānanda, Maṅgarāja and Śrī Haricandana — these three went along with Him, serving Him.

The Lord's chief companions on the journey to Vṛndāvana —

প্রভু-সঙ্গে পুরী-গোসাঞি, স্বরূপ-দামোদর ।
জগদানন্দ, মুকুন্দ, গোবিন্দ, কাশীশ্বর ॥ ১২৭ ॥

হরিদাস-ঠাকুর, আর পণ্ডিত-বক্রেশ্বর ।
গোপীনাথাচার্য্য, আর পণ্ডিত-দামোদর ॥ ১২৮ ॥

রামাই, নন্দাই, আর বহু ভক্তগণ ।
প্রধান কহিলুঁ, সবার কে করে গণন ॥ ১২৯ ॥

prabhu-saṅge purī-gosāñi, svarūpa-dāmodara
with the Lord Purī Gosāñi Svarūpa Dāmodara
jagadānanda, mukunda, govinda, kāśīśvara
Jagadānanda Mukunda Govinda Kāśīśvara
haridāsa-ṭhākura, āra paṇḍita-vakreśvara
Haridāsa Ṭhākura and Paṇḍita Vakreśvara
gopīnāthācārya, āra paṇḍita-dāmodara
Gopīnāthācārya and Paṇḍita Dāmodara
rāmāi, nandāi, āra bahu bhakta-gaṇa
Rāmāi Nandāi and many devotees
pradhāna kahiluṁ, sabāra ke kare gaṇana
the chief I have named of all who makes a count

127–129 With the Lord were Purī Gosāñi, Svarūpa Dāmodara, Jagadānanda, Mukunda, Govinda, Kāśīśvara, Haridāsa Ṭhākura, Vakreśvara Paṇḍita, Gopīnāthācārya, Dāmodara Paṇḍita, Rāmāi, Nandāi and many other devotees. I have named only the chief among them — who can count them all?

The incomparable love for Gaura of Gadādhara, to whom separation from the Lord for even a moment is agony —

গদাধর-পণ্ডিত যবে সঙ্গেতে চলিলা ।
ক্ষেত্র-সন্ন্যাস না ছাড়িহ — প্রভু নিষেধিলা ॥ ১৩০ ॥

gadādhara-paṇḍita yabe saṅgete calilā
Gadādhara Paṇḍita when along set out
kṣetra-sannyāsa nā chāḍiha — prabhu niṣedhilā
the kṣetra-sannyāsa not give up — the Lord forbade

130 When Gadādhara Paṇḍita set out with them, the Lord forbade him: “Do not give up your *kṣetra-sannyāsa*.”

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Kṣetra-sannyāsa. Some leave their former homes and live — alone or with their families — in some special (Viṣṇu-) *tīrtha*, that is, in Puruṣottama-kṣetra, in Navadvīpa-dhāma, in Mathurā-maṇḍala and similar places, regarding this as the highest goal. Their *āśrama* is called *kṣetra-sannyāsa*. This very *āśrama* is

the *vānaprastha-dharma* suited to the age of Kali. Sārvabhauma Bhaṭṭācārya's *kṣetra-sannyāsa* of this kind has been spoken of before.

*Longing for the Lord's company, the Paṇḍita unhesitatingly gives up even his *kṣetra-sannyāsa*, his residence in the *dhāma* —*

পণ্ডিত কহে, — যাঁহা তুমি, সেই নীলাচল ।
ক্ষেত্রসন্ন্যাস মোর যাউক রসাতল ॥ ১৩১ ॥

paṇḍita kahe, — yāṁhā tumi, sei nīlācala
the Paṇḍita says — where You that Nīlācala
kṣetrasannyāsa mora yāuka rasātala
kṣetra-sannyāsa my let go to Rasātala

131 The Paṇḍita said, “Wherever You are, that is Nīlācala. Let my *kṣetra-sannyāsa* go to Rasātala!”

Longing for the Lord's company, the Paṇḍita unhesitatingly gives up his service and breaks his vow of service —

প্রভু কহে, — ইঁহা কর গোপীনাথ সেবন ।
পণ্ডিত কহে, — কোটি-সেবা ত্বৎপাদ-দর্শন ॥ ১৩২ ॥

prabhu kahe, — iṁhā kara gopīnātha sevana
the Lord says — here do Gopīnātha’s service
paṇḍita kahe, — koṭi-sevā tvat-pāda-darśana
the Paṇḍita says — ten million services the sight of Your feet

132 The Lord said, “Stay here and serve Gopīnātha.” The Paṇḍita said, “Seeing Your feet is worth ten million services.”

Showing that He fears future blame on Himself, the Lord forbids the Paṇḍita to follow Him from Purī —

প্রভু কহে, — সেবা ছাড়িবে, আমায় লাগে দোষ ।
ইঁহা রহি’ সেবা কর, — আমার সন্তোষ ॥ ১৩৩ ॥

prabhu kahe, — sevā chāḍibe, āmāya lāge doṣa
the Lord says — the service you will give up to Me attaches the fault
iṁhā rahi' sevā kara, — āmāra santoṣa
here staying service do — My satisfaction

133 The Lord said, "If you give up the service, the fault will fall on Me. Stay here and serve — that will please Me."

Gadādhara's loving pique —

পণ্ডিত কহে, — সব দোষ আমার উপর ।
তোমা-সঙ্গে না যাইব, যাইব একেশ্বর ॥ ১৩৪ ॥

paṇḍita kahe, — saba doṣa āmāra upara
the Paṇḍita says — all fault me upon
tomā-saṅge nā yāiba, yāiba ekeśvara
with You not I shall go I shall go alone

134 The Paṇḍita said, "All the fault will fall on me. I shall not go with You; I shall go alone.

Anubhāṣya.
Ekeśvara: to this day in the Caṭṭagrāma region the word *aśvara*, a corruption of *ekeśvara*, is used in the sense of "alone." For the sake of Śrī Gaurāṅga's company Gadādhara made void his vow — to serve the form of Śrī Gopīnātha, who grants the fulfillment of every aim in life — and was ready to abandon lightly, without the least effort, even the service of Bhagavān. Śrī Gadādhara's love for Śrī Gaurāṅga is beyond the understanding of any devotee other than intimate friends who know the heart as he does.

'আই'কে দেখিতে যাইব, না যাইব তোমা লাগি' ।
'প্রতিজ্ঞা'-'সেবা'-ত্যাগ-দোষ, — তার আমি ভাগী ॥ ১৩৫ ॥

'āi'ke dekhite yāiba, nā yāiba tomā lāgi'
Āi to see I shall go not I shall go You for the sake of
'pratijñā'-'sevā'-tyāga-doṣa, — tāra āmi bhāgī
of giving up the vow and the service the fault — of that I the bearer

135 I shall go to see Āi (Mother Śacī), not for Your sake. The fault of giving up my vow and my service — that I shall bear myself."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Having received the service of Śrī Gopīnātha, Śrī Gadādhara Paṇḍita Gosvāmī had vowed to spend his whole life in that service. Had he gone with the Lord to Gauḍa, he would have committed two faults: "the fault of breaking a vow" and "the fault of abandoning service." On the path of *anurāga* great souls take all such faults upon themselves.

Having come from Purī to Kaṭaka, the Lord calls the Paṇḍita to Him —

এত বলি' পণ্ডিত-গোসাঞি পৃথক্ চলিলা ।
কটক আসি' প্রভু তাঁরে সঙ্গে আনাইলা ॥ ১৩৬ ॥

eta bali' paṇḍita-gosāñi pṛthak calilā
so saying Paṇḍita Gosāñi separately went
kaṭaka āsi' prabhu tāṁre saṅge ānāilā
to Kaṭaka coming the Lord him with had brought

136 Saying this, Paṇḍita Gosāñi travelled on separately. When the Lord reached Kaṭaka, He had him brought to Him.

*Gadādhara's pure love for Gaura alone is beyond those enchanted by majesty (*aiśvarya*) —*

পণ্ডিতের গৌরাঙ্গ প্রেম বুঝন না যায় ।
'প্রতিজ্ঞা', 'শ্রীকৃষ্ণ-সেবা' ছাড়িল তৃণপ্রায় ॥ ১৩৭ ॥

paṇḍitera gaurāṅga prema bujhana nā yāya
of the Paṇḍita for Gaurāṅga love to understand not is possible
'pratijñā', 'śrī-kṛṣṇa-sevā' chāḍila tṛṇa-prāya
the vow the service of Śrī Kṛṣṇa he gave up like a straw

137 The Paṇḍita's love for Gaurāṅga is beyond understanding: he gave up his vow and the service of Śrī Kṛṣṇa as though they were a blade of grass.

The Lord is pleased at heart but outwardly speaks with feigned anger —

তাঁহার চরিত্রে প্রভু অন্তরে সন্তোষ ।
তাঁহার হাতে ধরি' কহে, করি' প্রণয়-রোষ ॥ ১৩৮ ॥

tāṁhāra caritre prabhu antare santoṣa
his by the conduct the Lord inwardly satisfaction
tāṁhāra hāte dhari' kahe, kari' praṇaya-roṣa
his by the hand taking He says making loving anger

138 Inwardly the Lord was pleased with his conduct, but He took him by the hand and spoke with loving anger:

So far the Paṇḍita's aim has been fulfilled; now the Lord adjures him to go back to Purī and serve Gopīnātha —

'প্রতিজ্ঞা', 'সেবা' ছাড়িবে, — এ তোমার 'উদ্দেশ' ।
সে সিদ্ধ হইল — ছাড়ি' আইলা দূর দেশ ॥ ১৩৯ ॥

'pratijñā', 'sevā' chāḍibe, — e tomāra 'uddeśa'
the vow the service to give up — this your aim
se siddha haila — chāḍi' āilā dūra deśa
that accomplished became — leaving you have come far country

139 "You meant to give up your vow and your service, and you have succeeded: you have left them behind and come to a distant land.

The devotee gives happiness to Kṛṣṇa, and Kṛṣṇa to the devotee —

আমার সঙ্গে রহিতে চাহ, — বাঞ্ছ নিজ-'সুখ' ।
তোমার দুই ধর্ম্ম যায়, — আমার হয় 'দুঃখ' ॥ ১৪০ ॥

āmāra saṅge rahite cāha, — vāñcha nija-'sukha'
Me with to stay you want — you desire your own happiness
tomāra dui dharma yāya, — āmāra haya 'duḥkha'
your two duties go — Mine becomes sorrow

140 In wanting to stay with Me, you seek your own happiness. But you are failing in both your duties, and that makes Me sad.

মোর সুখ চাহ যদি, নীলাচলে চল ৷
আমার শপথ, যদি আর কিছু বল ॥ ১৪১ ॥

mora sukha cāha yadi, nīlācale cala
My happiness you want if to Nīlācala go
āmāra śapatha, yadi āra kichu bala
by Me sworn if more anything you say

141 If you want My happiness, go back to Nīlācala. I bind you by My oath — not one word more."

The Lord boards the boat; the Paṇḍita falls unconscious —

এত বলি' মহাপ্রভু নৌকাতে চড়িলা ৷
মূর্চ্ছিত হঞা পণ্ডিত তথা পড়িলা ॥ ১৪২ ॥

eta bali' mahāprabhu naukāte caḍilā
so saying Mahāprabhu into the boat climbed
mūrcchita hañā paṇḍita tathā paḍilā
unconscious becoming the Paṇḍita there fell

142 Saying this, Mahāprabhu got into the boat, and the Paṇḍita fell there unconscious.

The Lord orders Sārvabhauma to take the Paṇḍita with him —

পণ্ডিতে লঞা যাইতে সার্ব্বভৌমে আজ্ঞা দিলা ৷
ভট্টাচার্য্য কহে, — উঠ, ঐছে প্রভুর লীলা ॥ ১৪৩ ॥

paṇḍite lañā yāite sārvabhaume ājñā dilā
the Paṇḍita taking to go to Sārvabhauma order gave
bhaṭṭācārya kahe, — uṭha, aiche prabhura līlā
the Bhaṭṭācārya says — rise such of the Lord the līlā

143 The Lord ordered Sārvabhauma to take the Paṇḍita back with him. The Bhaṭṭācārya said, "Get up — such is the Lord's *līlā*.

The Bhaṭṭācārya consoles the Paṇḍita —

তুমি জান, কৃষ্ণ নিজ প্রতিজ্ঞা ছাড়িলা ।
ভক্ত কৃপা-বশে ভীষ্মের প্রতিজ্ঞা রাখিলা ॥ ১৪৪ ॥

tumi jāna, kṛṣṇa nija pratijñā chāḍilā
you know Kṛṣṇa His own vow gave up
bhakta kṛpā-vaśe bhīṣmera pratijñā rākhilā
for His devotee by mercy compelled Bhīṣma's vow He kept

144 You know how Kṛṣṇa gave up His own promise: moved by mercy for His devotee, He kept Bhīṣma's promise.

*Bhagavān breaks His own promise to keep His devotee's promise — (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, canto 1, chapter 9, verse 37)*

স্বনিগমমপহায় মৎ প্রতিজ্ঞা-
মৃতমধিকর্ত্তুমবপ্লুতো রথস্থঃ ।
ধৃতরথচরণোঽভ্যয়াচ্চলদ্গু-
র্হরিরিব হন্তুমিভং গতোত্তরীয়ঃ ॥ ১৪৫ ॥

sva-nigamam apahāya mat-pratijñām
His own promise giving up my promise
ṛtam adhikartum avapluto ratha-sthaḥ
true to make He jumped down standing on the chariot
dhṛta-ratha-caraṇo 'bhyayāc calad-gur
holding the chariot wheel He rushed the earth trembling
harir iva hantum ibhaṁ gatottarīyaḥ
a lion like to kill an elephant His upper cloth fallen

145 'To make my promise true, He gave up His own: He leapt down from the chariot, took up a chariot wheel and rushed at me like a lion about to kill an elephant; the earth trembled beneath Him, and His upper cloth fell away.' (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.9.37)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"I shall not take up weapons in the battle of Kurukṣetra" — this promise of His Kṛṣṇacandra gave up. Wishing to make my promise true, He got down from the

chariot, seized a wheel and, His upper cloth falling away, rushed forward to kill me.

Anubhāṣya.

Bhīṣmadeva, a *mahā-bhāgavata* who could choose the hour of his own passing, had described *bhāgavata-dharma* and the other, general *dharmas* to the Pāṇḍavas headed by Yudhiṣṭhira, who had come with Śrī Kṛṣṇa. Then, seeing that the time of *uttarāyaṇa* had come and understanding that his departure was near, he offers prayers to Śrī Kṛṣṇa, who stands before him:

sva-nigamam (His own promise: "I shall protect the Pāṇḍavas without taking up weapons") **apahāya** (giving up) **mat-pratijñāṁ** (my promise, the resolve "I shall make Śrī Kṛṣṇa take up a weapon") **ṛtam** (true) **adhi** (all the more) **kartum** (to make) **ratha-sthaḥ** (standing on the chariot) **avaplutaḥ** (suddenly getting down) **dhṛta-ratha-caraṇaḥ** (He who seized a chariot wheel) **calad-guḥ** (He by whose fury the earth trembled) **gatottarīyaḥ** (He whose upper cloth, by that same fury, fell on the road) **ibham** (an elephant) **hantum** (to kill) **hariḥ** (a lion) **iva** (like) **abhyayāt** (rushed forward; it connects with the next verse: "may He be my Lord").

The Lord protects the Paṇḍita's vow —

এইমত প্রভু তোমার বিচ্ছেদ সহিয়া ।
তোমার প্রতিজ্ঞা রক্ষা কৈল যত্ন করিয়া ॥ ১৪৬ ॥

ei mata prabhu tomāra viccheda sahiyā
in this way the Lord your separation enduring
tomāra pratijñā rakṣā kaila yatna kariyā
your vow protection made effort making

146 In the same way the Lord endured separation from you and took great pains to protect your vow."

The Bhaṭṭācārya comes to Purī with the Paṇḍita —

এইমত কহি' তাঁরে প্রবোধ করিলা ।
দুইজনে শোকাকুল নীলাচলে আইলা ॥ ১৪৭ ॥

ei mata kahi' tāṁre prabodha karilā
in this way saying him consolation gave
dui-jane śokākula nīlācale āilā
the two stricken with grief to Nīlācala came

147 With these words the Bhaṭṭācārya consoled the Paṇḍita, and the two of them, stricken with grief, came back to Nīlācala.

*For Kṛṣṇa's sake the devotee easily gives up his own *dharma*, and for this Kṛṣṇa is in his debt —*

প্রভু লাগি' ধর্ম্ম-কর্ম্ম ছাড়ে ভক্তগণ ।
ভক্ত-ধর্ম্ম-হানি প্রভুর না হয় সহন ॥ ১৪৮ ॥

prabhu lāgi' dharma-karma chāḍe bhakta-gaṇa
the Lord for the sake of religious duties and works give up the devotees
bhakta-dharma-hāni prabhura nā haya sahana
of the devotees duty the loss for the Lord not is bearable

148 For the Lord's sake the devotees give up their religious duties and works, yet the Lord cannot bear to see a devotee's duty suffer.

*For the devotee to suffer in separation from Bhagavān is natural, but Bhagavān's suffering in separation from the devotee is *prema-vivarta* (the paradox of love); whoever hears of it attains Caitanya —*

'প্রেমের বিবর্ত্ত' ইহা শুনে যেই জন ।
অচিরে মিলয়ে তাঁরে চৈতন্য-চরণ ॥ ১৪৯ ॥

'premera vivarta' ihā śune yei jana
of love the strange turns this hears whoever person
acire milaye tāṁre caitanya-caraṇa
soon are attained by him Caitanya's feet

149 These are the strange turns of love (*premera vivarta*). Whoever hears of them soon attains Caitanya's feet.[6]

*At Yājapura the Lord bids farewell to the two *mahāpātras* —*

দুই রাজপাত্র যেই প্রভু-সঙ্গে যায় ।
'যাজপুর' আসি' প্রভু তারে দিলেন বিদায় ॥ ১৫০ ॥

dui rāja-pātra yei prabhu-saṅge yāya
two royal officers who with the Lord were going
'yājapura' āsi' prabhu tāre dilena vidāya
to Yājapura coming the Lord to them gave leave

150 When the Lord came to Yājapura, He bade farewell to the two royal officers who were travelling with Him.

Anubhāṣya.

Yājapura is a subdivision of Kaṭaka district, situated on the southern bank of the river Vaitaraṇī. The place got the name "Yājapura" from the sacrifices (*yajña*) that the sages performed on the left bank; according to some, the name "Yājapura" comes from "Yayāti-nagara." The *Mahābhārata*, Vana-parva, chapter 114: "Here are the Kaliṅgas, O son of Kuntī, where the river Vaitaraṇī flows. Here even Dharma, taking shelter of the gods, offered sacrifice to them. Here too in ancient times the sages and others worshiped with sacrifices." There are countless forms of the gods here; among them the form of Śrī Varāhadeva is especially worshiped. Worshipers of Śakti worship the Mothers — Vārāhī, Vaiṣṇavī, Indrāṇī and others. There are also many forms of Śiva and the Daśāśvamedha-ghāṭa. This place is also called Nābhi-gayā, Virajā-kṣetra and so on.

The Lord talks of Kṛṣṇa constantly with His companion Rāya —

প্রভু বিদায় দিল, রায় যায় তাঁর সনে ।
কৃষ্ণকথা রামানন্দ-সনে রাত্রি দিনে ॥ ১৫১ ॥

prabhu vidāya dila, rāya yāya tāṁra sane
the Lord leave gave Rāya goes with Him
kṛṣṇa-kathā rāmānanda-sane rātri dine
talks of Kṛṣṇa with Rāmānanda night day

151 The Lord sent them back, but Rāya went on with Him, and night and day He talked of Kṛṣṇa with Rāmānanda.

By the king's order, the royal officers receive the Lord in every village —

প্রতিগ্রামে রাজ-আজ্ঞায় রাজভৃত্যগণ ।
নব্য-গৃহে নানা-দ্রব্যে করয়ে সেবন ॥ ১৫২ ॥

prati-grāme rāja-ājñāya rāja-bhṛtya-gaṇa
in every village by the king's order the king's servants
navya-gṛhe nānā-dravye karaye sevana
in a new house with all kinds of provisions do service

152 In every village, by royal order, the king's servants served Him with a new house and all kinds of provisions.

At Remuṇā (?) the Lord lets Rāya go —

এইমত চলি' প্রভু 'রেমুণা' আইলা ।
তথা হৈতে রামানন্দ-রায়ে বিদায় দিলা ॥ ১৫৩ ॥

ei mata cali' prabhu 'remuṇā' āilā
in this way traveling the Lord to Remuṇā came
tathā haite rāmānanda-rāye vidāya dilā
from there to Rāmānanda Rāya leave gave

153 Travelling in this way, the Lord came to Remuṇā, and from there He sent Rāmānanda Rāya back.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Many accounts describe that Mahāprabhu, travelling in this way together with Rāmānanda Rāya, let Rāmānanda Rāya go from Bhadraka — before He reached Remuṇā near Bāleśvara.

Anubhāṣya.

"From there": another reading has "from Bhadraka." If "from there" is taken to mean "from Remuṇā," it disagrees with the reading of Madhya 1.149: "Rāmānanda Rāya accompanied Him as far as Bhadraka." Some hold that Remuṇā then belonged to the Bhadraka district, but there is no evidence for this. Others hold that in the verse just mentioned "Remuṇā" is the right reading in place of "Bhadraka." It seems more likely, however, that Rāya turned back from Bhadraka. Bhadraka

lies four *yojanas* south of Bāleśvara, and Remuṇā about half a *yojana* (5 miles) to its west.

Rāya faints; the Lord weeps —

ভূমেতে পড়িলা রায় নাহিক চেতন ।
রায়ে কোলে করি' প্রভু করয়ে ক্রন্দন ॥ ১৫৪ ॥

bhūmete paḍilā rāya nāhika cetana
to the ground fell Rāya there was no consciousness
rāye kole kari' prabhu karaye krandana
Rāya on the lap taking the Lord does weeping

154 Rāya fell to the ground unconscious, and the Lord took him on His lap and wept.

Rāya's grief at parting from the Lord is beyond description —

রায়ের বিদায়-ভাব না যায় সহন ।
কহিতে না পারি এই তাহার বর্ণন ॥ ১৫৫ ॥

rāyera vidāya-bhāva nā yāya sahana
Rāya's feelings at parting not can be borne
kahite nā pāri ei tāhāra varṇana
to tell not I can this its description

155 Rāya's grief at parting was unbearable; I cannot describe it.

The Lord reaches the border of Orissa; a royal officer serves the Lord —

তবে 'ওড্রদেশ-সীমা' প্রভু চলি' আইলা ।
তথা রাজ-অধিকারী প্রভুরে মিলিলা ॥ ১৫৬ ॥

tabe 'oḍhra-deśa-sīmā' prabhu cali' āilā
then to the border of the land of Oḍhra the Lord traveling came
tathā rāja-adhikārī prabhure mililā
there the royal governor the Lord met

156 Then the Lord came to the border of the land of Oḍhra, and there the king's governor met Him.

Anubhāṣya.

The border of Oḍra-deśa. The Suvarṇarekhā river forms the border between Bengal and Utkala; it flows past the *śrīpāṭa* of Gopīvallabhapura and on into Orissa.

দিন দুই-চারি তেঁহো করিল সেবন ।
আগে চলিবারে সেই কহে বিবরণ ॥ ১৫৭ ॥

dina dui-cāri teṁho karila sevana
days two or four he did service
āge calibāre sei kahe vivaraṇa
ahead for going on he tells the particulars

157 He served the Lord for a few days and then explained to Him what lay ahead on the road.

The royal officer shows the Lord where the Hindu kingdom ends and the Muslim one begins, and describes the road —

মদ্যপ যবন-রাজার আগে অধিকার ।
তাঁর ভয়ে পথে কেহ নারে চলিবার ॥ ১৫৮ ॥

madyapa yavana-rājāra āge adhikāra
drunken of the yavana king ahead the domain
tāṁra bhaye pathe keha nāre calibāra
his from fear on the road anyone cannot travel

158 "Ahead lies the domain of a drunken *yavana* king. For fear of him no one can travel this road.

পিছলদা পর্য্যন্ত সব তাঁর অধিকার ।
তাঁর ভয়ে নদী কেহ হৈতে নারে পার ॥ ১৫৯ ॥

pichaladā paryanta saba tāṁra adhikāra
Picchaladā as far as all his domain
tāṁra bhaye nadī keha haite nāre pāra
his from fear the river anyone to get cannot across

159 All the land as far as Picchaladā is his, and for fear of him no one can cross the river.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Pichaladā is a village named Pichaladā on the bank of the Rūpanārāyaṇa river, near Tamluk (?).

He promises to help the Lord continue His journey once he has made peace with the Muslim ruler —

দিন কত রহ, — সন্ধি করি' তাঁর সনে ।
তবে সুখে নৌকাতে করাইব গমনে ॥ ১৬০ ॥

dina kata raha, — sandhi kari' tāṁra sane
days a few stay a truce making with him
tabe sukhe naukāte karāiba gamane
then comfortably by boat I shall arrange the journey

160 Stay here a few days. I will make a truce with him, and then I will send You on comfortably by boat."

A spy of the Muslim ruler tells his master what the Lord and His companions do and how great they are —

সেই কালে সে যবনের এক অনুচর ।
ওড়িয়া-কটকে আইলা করি' বেশান্তর ॥ ১৬১ ॥

sei kāle se yavanera eka anucara
at that time that yavana's one follower
oḍiyā-kaṭake āilā kari' veśāntara
to the Oriyā camp came making a change of dress

161 At that time one of that *yavana*'s men came to the Oriyā camp in disguise.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The Oṛiyā *kaṭaka* is the “army camp” (*sainya-kaṭaka*), that is, the encampment on the frontier of the Utkala king's realm; it is what the verse calls the “Oṛiyā *kaṭaka*.”

Anubhāṣya.

“In disguise”: that is, though himself a Yavana, he exchanged a Yavana's dress for a Hindu's.

প্রভুর সেই অদ্ভুত চরিত্র দেখিয়া।
হিন্দু-চর কহে, সেই যবন-পাশ গিয়া ॥ ১৬২ ॥

prabhura sei adbhuta caritra dekhiyā
the Lord’s that wonderful conduct seeing
hindu-cara kahe, sei yavana-pāśa giyā
the Hindu spy says to that yavana going

162 Seeing the Lord’s wonderful ways, the spy in his Hindu guise went back to the *yavana* and said,

Anubhāṣya.

A *cara* (spy) is one who secretly learns all the inner affairs, whether of the enemy or of one's own subjects. He hides who he is, passes himself off as someone else, and brings exact news to the one who employed or sent him.

এক সন্ন্যাসী আইল জগন্নাথ হৈতে।
অনেক সিদ্ধ-পুরুষ হয় তাঁহার সহিতে ॥ ১৬৩ ॥

eka sannyāsī āila jagannātha haite
one sannyāsī has come Jagannātha from
aneka siddha-puruṣa haya tāṁhāra sahite
many perfected men are Him with

163 “A *sannyāsī* has come from Jagannātha, and many perfected souls are with Him.

নিরন্তর করে সবে কৃষ্ণ-সংকীর্ত্তন ।
সবে হাসে, নাচে, গায়, করয়ে ক্রন্দন ॥ ১৬৪ ॥

nirantara kare sabe kṛṣṇa-saṅkīrtana
constantly perform all the saṅkīrtana of Kṛṣṇa
sabe hāse, nāce, gāya, karaye krandana
all laugh dance sing do weeping

164 All of them constantly perform the *saṅkīrtana* of Kṛṣṇa, laughing, dancing, singing and weeping.

লক্ষ লক্ষ লোক আইসে তাহা দেখিবারে ।
তাঁরে দেখি' পুনরপি যাইতে নারে ঘরে ॥ ১৬৫ ॥

lakṣa lakṣa loka āise tāhā dekhibāre
hundreds of thousands hundreds of thousands people come it to see
tāṁre dekhi' punarapi yāite nāre ghare
Him seeing again to go cannot home

165 Hundreds of thousands of people come to see it, and once they have seen Him, they cannot go home again.

সেই সব লোক হয় বাউলের প্রায় ।
'কৃষ্ণ' কহি' নাচে, কান্দে, গড়াগড়ি যায় ॥ ১৬৬ ॥

sei saba loka haya bāulera prāya
those all people become madmen like
'kṛṣṇa' kahi' nāce, kānde, gaḍāgaḍi yāya
"Kṛṣṇa" saying dance weep rolling on the ground go

166 All those people become like madmen: crying 'Kṛṣṇa!', they dance, weep and roll on the ground.

কহিবার কথা নহে, — দেখিলে সে জানি ।
তাঁহার প্রভাবে তাঁরে 'ঈশ্বর' করি মানি ॥ ১৬৭ ॥

kahibāra kathā nahe, — dekhile se jāni
for telling a matter it is not if one sees that one knows
tāṁhāra prabhāve tāṁre 'īśvara' kari māni
His by the power Him "God" as I accept

167 It is not something one can describe; one knows it only by seeing it. Such is His power that I accept Him as God (*Īśvara*)."

*The spy is overcome by *prema* —*

এত কহি' সেই চর 'হরি' 'কৃষ্ণ' গায়।
হাসে, কান্দে, নাচে, গায় বাউলের প্রায় ॥ ১৬৮ ॥

eta kahi' sei cara 'hari' 'kṛṣṇa' gāya
this saying that spy "Hari" "Kṛṣṇa" sings
hāse, kānde, nāce, gāya bāulera prāya
laughs weeps dances sings a madman like

168 Saying this, the spy himself began to sing "Hari! Kṛṣṇa!", laughing, weeping, dancing and singing like a madman.

Hearing about the Lord from the spy, the Muslim ruler sends his minister to the Lord —

এত শুনি' যবনের মন ফিরি' গেল।
আপন 'বিশ্বাস' ওড়িয়া স্থানে পাঠাইল ॥ ১৬৯ ॥

eta śuni' yavanera mana phiri' gela
this hearing the yavana's mind turning went
āpana 'viśvāsa' oḍiyā sthāne pāṭhāila
his own secretary (*viśvāsa*) of the Oriyā to the place sent

169 Hearing this, the *yavana* had a change of heart, and he sent his own secretary (*viśvāsa*) to the Oriyā officer.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Viśvāsa. The Yavana ruler of the land of Gauḍa had a department (*daptar*) called the *viśvāsa-khānā*. Only the most trustworthy Kāyasthas were given posts

in it. Whenever the king had important business somewhere, Kāyastha *viśvāsas* were sent there.

*The minister bows at the Lord's feet and is overcome by *prema* —*

'বিশ্বাস' আসিয়া প্রভুর চরণ বন্দিল ।
'কৃষ্ণ' 'কৃষ্ণ' কহি' প্রেমে বিহ্বল হইল ॥ ১৭০ ॥

'viśvāsa' āsiyā prabhura caraṇa vandila
the secretary coming the Lord's feet worshipped
'kṛṣṇa' 'kṛṣṇa' kahi' preme vihvala haila
"Kṛṣṇa" "Kṛṣṇa" saying in love overwhelmed became

170 The secretary came and bowed at the Lord's feet, and, crying "Kṛṣṇa! Kṛṣṇa!", he was overwhelmed with love.

He humbly addresses the royal officer and asks for peace —

ধৈর্য্য হঞা ওড়িয়াকে কহে নমস্করি' ।
তোমা-স্থানে পাঠাইলা ম্লেচ্ছ অধিকারী ॥ ১৭১ ॥

dhairya hañā oḍiyāke kahe namaskari'
composed becoming to the Oriyā he says bowing
tomā-sthāne pāṭhāilā mleccha adhikārī
to you has sent the mleccha governor

171 Composing himself, he bowed to the Oriyā officer and said, "The *mleccha* governor has sent me to you.

তুমি যদি আজ্ঞা দেহ' এথাকে আসিয়া ।
যবন অধিকারী যায় প্রভুকে মিলিয়া ॥ ১৭২ ॥

tumi yadi ājñā deha' ethāke āsiyā
you if permission give here coming
yavana adhikārī yāya prabhuke miliyā
the yavana governor will go the Lord having met

172 If you give permission, the *yavana* governor will come here, meet the Lord and go back.

বহুত উৎকণ্ঠা তাঁর, কর্য্যাছে বিনয়।
তোমা-সনে এই সন্ধি, নাহি যুদ্ধ ভয় ॥ ১৭৩ ॥

bahuta utkaṇṭhā tāṁra, karyāche vinaya
great eagerness his he has shown humility
tomā-sane ei sandhi, nāhi yuddha bhaya
with you this truce there is no of war fear

173 He is very eager and has asked most humbly. This is a truce with you; there need be no fear of war."

The royal officer marvels that the Lord has changed the Muslim ruler's heart

—

শুনি' মহাপাত্র কহে হঞা বিস্ময়।
মদ্যপ যবনের চিত্ত ঐছে কে করয়! ॥ ১৭৪ ॥

śuni' mahā-pātra kahe hañā vismaya
hearing the Mahāpātra says becoming amazed
madyapa yavanera citta aiche ke karaya!
of the drunken yavana the heart like this who makes

174 Hearing this, the Mahāpātra was amazed and said, "Who could make the heart of a drunken *yavana* like this?

আপনে মহাপ্রভু তাঁর মন ফিরাইল।
দর্শন-স্মরণে যাঁর জগৎ তারিল ॥ ১৭৫ ॥

āpane mahāprabhu tāṁra mana phirāila
Himself Mahāprabhu his mind has turned
darśana-smaraṇe yāṁra jagat tārila
by seeing and remembering whom the world is delivered

175 It is Mahāprabhu Himself who has changed his heart: the whole world is delivered by seeing Him and by remembering Him."

*The Muslim ruler is allowed to come for the Lord's *darśana* —*

এত বলি' বিশ্বাসেরে কহিল বচন ।
ভাগ্য তাঁর — আসি' করুক প্রভু দরশন ॥ ১৭৬ ॥

eta bali' viśvāsere kahila vacana
this saying to the secretary spoke words
bhāgya tāṁra — āsi' karuka prabhu daraśana
fortune his coming let him have of the Lord sight

176 Saying this, he told the secretary, "It is his good fortune. Let him come and see the Lord.

প্রতীত করিয়ে — যদি নিরস্ত্র হঞা ।
আসে তেঁহো পাঁচ-সাত ভৃত্য সঙ্গে লঞা ॥ ১৭৭ ॥

pratīta kariye — yadi nirastra hañā
trust I shall place if unarmed being
āse teṁho pāṁca-sāta bhṛtya saṅge lañā
comes he five or seven servants with him bringing

177 I will trust him if he comes unarmed, bringing only five or seven servants with him."

The minister brings this joyful news; the Muslim comes to see the Lord disguised as a Hindu —

'বিশ্বাস' যাঞা তাঁহারে সকল কহিল ।
হিন্দুবেশ ধরি' সেই যবন আইল ॥ ১৭৮ ॥

'viśvāsa' yāñā tāṁhāre sakala kahila
the secretary going to him everything told
hindu-veśa dhari' sei yavana āila
a Hindu's dress putting on that yavana came

178 The secretary went and told him everything, and the *yavana* came dressed as a Hindu.

দূর হৈতে প্রভু দেখি' ভূমেতে পড়িয়া ।
দণ্ডবৎ করে অশ্রু-পুলকিত হঞা ॥ ১৭৯ ॥

dūra haite prabhu dekhi' bhūmete paḍiyā
from afar the Lord seeing to the ground falling
daṇḍavat kare aśru-pulakita hañā
prostration makes with tears and thrilling hair becoming

179 Seeing the Lord from afar, he fell to the ground in prostrate obeisance, in tears and with his hair standing on end.

Coming before the Lord, the Muslim utters the name of Kṛṣṇa —

মহাপাত্র আনিল তাঁরে করিয়া সম্মান ।
যোড়-হাতে প্রভু-আগে লয় কৃষ্ণনাম ॥ ১৮০ ॥

mahā-pātra ānila tāṁre kariyā sammāna
the Mahāpātra brought him showing honour
yoḍa-hāte prabhu-āge laya kṛṣṇa-nāma
with joined palms before the Lord he takes the name of Kṛṣṇa

180 The Mahāpātra brought him forward with honour, and with joined palms he chanted the name of Kṛṣṇa before the Lord:

*He curses his birth as a Muslim and speaks words of bitter despondency (*nirveda*) —*

অধম যবনকুলে কেন জন্ম হৈল ।
বিধি মোরে হিন্দুকুলে কেনে না জন্মাইল ॥ ১৮১ ॥

adhama yavana-kule kena janma haila
in a low yavana family why birth took place
vidhi more hindu-kule kene nā janmāila
Providence me in a Hindu family why not caused to be born

181 “Why was I born in a low *yavana* family? Why did Providence not have me born in a Hindu family?

Without attaining the Lord's feet he longs for death —

‘হিন্দু’ হৈলে পাইতাম তোমার চরণ-সন্নিধান ।
ব্যর্থ মোর এই দেহ, যাউক পরাণ ॥ ১৮২ ॥

‘hindu’ haile pāitāma tomāra caraṇa-sannidhāna
a Hindu had I been I would have gained Your nearness to the feet
vyartha mora ei deha, yāuka parāṇa
useless my this body let it go life

182 Had I been a Hindu, I would have gained a place near Your feet. This body of mine is useless — let my life go!”

Hearing his lament, the royal officer too offers prayers to the Lord —

এত শুনি’ মহাপাত্র আবিষ্ট হঞা ।
প্রভুকে করেন স্তুতি চরণে ধরিয়া ॥ ১৮৩ ॥

eta śuni’ mahā-pātra āviṣṭa hañā
this hearing the Mahāpātra overwhelmed becoming
prabhuke karena stuti caraṇe dhariyā
to the Lord offers praise the feet clasping

183 Hearing this, the Mahāpātra was overwhelmed with feeling; clasping the Lord’s feet, he praised Him:

*Even an *antyaja* (one born outside the *varṇas*) becomes pure simply by hearing the Lord's name —*

চণ্ডাল — পবিত্র, যাঁর শ্রীনাম-শ্রবণে ।
হেন-তোমার এই জীব পাইল দর্শনে ॥ ১৮৪ ॥

caṇḍāla — pavitra, yāṁra śrī-nāma-śravaṇe
an outcaste is purified whose holy name by hearing
hena-tomāra ei jīva pāila darśane
such You this soul has obtained sight

184 "By hearing Your holy name even a *caṇḍāla* becomes pure — and this soul has gained the sight of such a Lord as You!

That the Muslim was delivered by seeing the Lord is not so astonishing —

ইঁহার যে এই গতি, ইথে কি বিস্ময় ?
তোমার দর্শন-প্রভাব এইমত হয় ॥ ১৮৫ ॥

iṁhāra ye ei gati, ithe ki vismaya?
his that this state in this what wonder
tomāra darśana-prabhāva ei mata haya
Your sight's power this way is

185 What wonder is there in his coming to such a state? Such is the power of seeing You."

*Hearing, chanting or remembering the Lord's name purifies even an *antyaja* — what then of seeing Him face to face — (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 3.33.6) —*

যন্নামধেয়শ্রবণানুকীর্ত্তনাদ্-
যৎপ্রহ্বণাদ্যৎস্মরণাদপি ক্বচিৎ ।
শ্বাদোঽপি সদ্যঃ সবনায় কল্পতে
কুতঃ পুনস্তে ভগবন্নু দর্শনাৎ ॥ ১৮৬ ॥

yan-nāmadheya-śravaṇānukīrtanād
whose name from hearing and chanting
yat-prahvaṇād yat-smaraṇād api kvacit
to whom from bowing of whom from remembering even once
śvādo 'pi sadyaḥ savanāya kalpate
a dog-eater even at once for Vedic sacrifice becomes fit
kutaḥ punas te bhagavan nu darśanāt
how much more then You O Lord indeed from seeing

186 “O Lord, if even a dog-eater hears and chants Your name, bows down to You or remembers You but once, he is instantly made fit to perform Vedic sacrifice. How much more, then, one who sees You!” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 3.33.6)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

O Bhagavān, even one born in a family of *caṇḍālas* or Yavanas at once becomes fit for the *savana* sacrifice as soon as he hears Your name, repeats it after hearing it, bows to You and remembers You. Such a Lord You are — what does the sight of You not bestow?

Anubhāṣya.

When mother Devahūti heard from Śrī Kapiladeva about the yoga of pure *bhakti*, the covering of delusion fell away from her, and she offers prayers to Bhagavān Śrī Kapiladeva, the founder of pure *sāṅkhya* knowledge:

bhagavan (O Bhagavān), **kvacit yan-nāmadheya-śravaṇānukīrtanāt** (by first hearing the name of You, Bhagavān, and then — *anu* — chanting it), **yat-prahvaṇāt** (by bowing one's head to You), **yat-smaraṇāt** (by remembering You, Bhagavān) **ca śvādaḥ** (one born in a family of dog-eaters, the lowest of all) **api sadyaḥ** (at once) **savanāya** (for the *soma* sacrifice) **kalpate** (becomes fit); **te** (Your) **darśanāt punaḥ kutaḥ nu** (what need is there to say; the sense is, “I have attained the goal”).

The Lord mercifully tells the Muslim ruler to chant the name of Kṛṣṇa —

তবে মহাপ্রভু তাঁরে কৃপা-দৃষ্টি করি’ ।
আশ্বাসিয়া কহে, — তুমি কহ ‘কৃষ্ণ’ ‘হরি’ ॥ ১৮৭ ॥

tabe mahāprabhu tāṁre kṛpā-dṛṣṭi kari’
then Mahāprabhu on him a merciful glance casting
āśvāsiyā kahe, — tumi kaha ‘kṛṣṇa’ ‘hari’
reassuring says you say “Kṛṣṇa” “Hari”

187 Then Mahāprabhu cast a merciful glance on him and, reassuring him, said, “Chant ‘Kṛṣṇa’ and ‘Hari’.”

Anubhāṣya.

“Him”: that *mleccha* ruler.

*The *mleccha* ruler asks to be freed from his sins and to be given service to the Lord —*

সেই কহে, — মোরে যদি কৈলা অঙ্গীকার ।
এক আজ্ঞা দেহ, — সেবা করি যে তোমার ॥ ১৮৮ ॥

sei kahe, — more yadi kailā aṅgīkāra
he says me if You have made acceptance
eka ājñā deha, — sevā kari ye tomāra
one order give service I may do that Your

188 He said, “If You have accepted me, give me one order, so that I may serve You.

গো-ব্রাহ্মণ-বৈষ্ণবে হিংসা কর্যাছি অপার ।
সেই পাপ হইতে মোর হউক নিস্তার ॥ ১৮৯ ॥

go-brāhmaṇa-vaiṣṇave hiṁsā karyāchi apāra
to cows, brāhmaṇas and Vaiṣṇavas violence I have done boundless
sei pāpa haite mora hauka nistāra
that sin from my may there be deliverance

189 I have done endless violence to cows, brāhmaṇas and Vaiṣṇavas. May I be delivered from that sin.”

Mukunda asks him to help on the journey of the Lord, who is playing the part of an ordinary man —

তবে মুকুন্দ দত্ত কহে, — শুন, মহাশয় ।
গঙ্গাতীর যাইতে মহাপ্রভুর মন হয় ॥ ১৯০ ॥

tabe mukunda datta kahe, — śuna, mahāśaya
then Mukunda Datta says listen good sir
gaṅgā-tīra yāite mahāprabhura mana haya
to the bank of the Gaṅgā to go Mahāprabhu’s mind is

190 Then Mukunda Datta said, “Listen, good sir: Mahāprabhu wishes to go to the bank of the Gaṅgā.

তাঁহা যাইতে কর তুমি সহায়-প্রকার ।
এই বড় আজ্ঞা, এই বড় উপকার ॥ ১৯১ ॥

tāṁhā yāite kara tumi sahāya-prakāra
there to go give you of help some form
ei baḍa ājñā, ei baḍa upakāra
this the great order this the great service

191 Help Him in some way to get there. That is the great order, and that will be a great service."

*The *mleccha* ruler agrees, bows humbly to everyone and takes his leave —*

তবে সেই মহাপ্রভুর চরণ বন্দিয়া ।
সবার চরণ বন্দি' চলে হৃষ্ট হঞা ॥ ১৯২ ॥

tabe sei mahāprabhura caraṇa vandiyā
then he Mahāprabhu's feet worshipping
sabāra caraṇa vandi' cale hṛṣṭa hañā
everyone's feet worshipping goes joyful becoming

192 Then he bowed at Mahāprabhu's feet and at the feet of all, and went away rejoicing.

Anubhāṣya.
"He": the *mleccha* ruler.

He embraces the royal officer and makes friends with him —

মহাপাত্র তাঁর সনে কৈল কোলাকুলি ।
অনেক সামগ্রী দিয়া করিল মিতালি ॥ ১৯৩ ॥

mahāpātra tāṁra sane kaila kolākuli
the Mahāpātra him with exchanged embraces
aneka sāmagrī diyā karila mitāli
many gifts giving made friendship

193 The Mahāpātra embraced him and, giving him many gifts, made friends with him.

Anubhāṣya.

Mitāli: friendship sealed with gifts and the like.

*In the morning the *mleccha* helps the Lord set out and invites Him with honour —*

প্রাতঃকালে সেই বহু নৌকা সাজাঞা ।
প্রভুকে আনিতে দিল বিশ্বাস পাঠাঞা ॥ ১৯৪ ॥

prātaḥ-kāle sei bahu naukā sājāñā
in the morning he many boats fitting out
prabhuke ānite dila viśvāsa pāṭhāñā
the Lord to bring he did the secretary sending

194 In the morning the *yavana* fitted out many boats and sent his secretary to bring the Lord.

*The Lord comes with the royal officer, and the *mleccha* bows at the Lord's feet —*

মহাপাত্র চলি' আইলা মহাপ্রভুর সনে ।
ম্লেচ্ছ আসি' কৈল প্রভুর চরণ বন্দনে ॥ ১৯৫ ॥

mahā-pātra cali' āilā mahāprabhura sane
the Mahāpātra traveling came Mahāprabhu with
mleccha āsi' kaila prabhura caraṇa vandane
the mleccha coming made the Lord's feet worship

195 The Mahāpātra came along with Mahāprabhu, and the *mleccha* came and worshipped the Lord's feet.

He gives the Lord a new boat with every comfort —

এক নবীন নৌকা, তার মধ্যে ঘর ।
স্বগণে চড়াইলা প্রভু তাহার উপর ॥ ১৯৬ ॥

eka navīna naukā, tāra madhye ghara
one new boat its in the middle a cabin
sva-gaṇe caḍāilā prabhu tāhāra upara
with His companions had board the Lord it upon

196 There was one new boat with a cabin in the middle, and the Lord went on board with His companions.

On the riverbank the Lord bids farewell to the royal officer, who weeps —

মহাপাত্রে মহাপ্রভু করিলা বিদায় ।
কান্দিতে কান্দিতে সেই তীরে রহি' চায় ॥ ১৯৭ ॥

mahā-pātre mahāprabhu karilā vidāya
the Mahāpātra Mahāprabhu gave leave
kāndite kāndite sei tīre rahi' cāya
weeping weeping he on the bank remaining gazes

197 Mahāprabhu bade the Mahāpātra farewell, and he stood weeping on the bank, gazing after Him.

*That *mleccha*, now a devotee of the Lord, guards Him, takes Him across the Mantreśvara river and accompanies Him as far as Pichaladā —*

জলদস্যুভয়ে সেই যবন চলিল ।
দশ নৌকা ভরি' বহু সৈন্য সঙ্গে নিল ॥ ১৯৮ ॥

jala-dasyu-bhaye sei yavana calila
for fear of river pirates that yavana went along
daśa naukā bhari' bahu sainya saṅge nila
ten boats filling many soldiers with him took

198 For fear of river pirates the *yavana* went along too, taking many soldiers with him in ten boats.

'মন্ত্রেশ্বর'-দুষ্টনদে পার করাইল ।
'পিছল্দা' পর্য্যন্ত যেই যবন আইল ॥ ১৯৯ ॥

'mantreśvara'-duṣṭa-nade pāra karāila
Mantreśvara the dangerous river across he brought them
'pichaldā' paryanta yei yavana āila
Picchaldā as far as who yavana came

199 He brought them across the dangerous Mantreśvara river, and the *yavana* came with them all the way to Picchaldā.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Mantreśvara is the name of a large river near Diamond Harbour. Along this river the boat came to the village of Pichaladā on the bank of the Rūpanārāyaṇa; on one side the village of Pichaladā borders the Mantreśvara (?).

Anubhāṣya.
The dangerous river (*duṣṭa-nada*): a hard waterway infested with river pirates. It is hard also because the river is very wide and swift.

At Pichaladā the Lord lets him go; his wondrous grief —

তাঁরে বিদায় দিল প্রভু সেই গ্রাম হৈতে ।
সে-কালে তাঁর প্রেম-চেষ্টা না পারি বর্ণিতে ॥ ২০০ ॥

tāṁre vidāya dila prabhu sei grāma haite
him leave gave the Lord that village from
se-kāle tāṁra prema-ceṣṭā nā pāri varṇite
at that time his signs of love not I can describe

200 From that village the Lord bade him farewell. I cannot describe the signs of love he showed then.

Only one who hears of Caitanya's pastimes has made his birth fruitful —

অলৌকিক লীলা করে শ্রীকৃষ্ণচৈতন্য ।
যেই ইহা শুনে, তাঁর জন্ম, দেহ ধন্য ॥ ২০১ ॥

alaukika līlā kare śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya
beyond this world pastimes performs Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya
yei ihā śune, tāṁra janma, deha dhanya
whoever this hears his birth body are blessed

201 Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya performs pastimes beyond this world. Whoever hears of them is blessed in his birth and in his body.

In that boat the Lord arrives at Pāṇihāṭī, at Rāghava's house, and shows mercy to the boatman —

সেই নৌকা চড়ি' প্রভু আইলা 'পানিহাটি' ।
নাবিকেরে পরাইল প্রভু নিজ-কৃপা-সাটী ॥ ২০২ ॥

sei naukā caḍi' prabhu āilā 'pānihāṭi'
that boat riding the Lord came to Pāṇihāṭi
nāvikere parāila prabhu nija-kṛpā-sāṭī
the boatman clothed the Lord in the cloth of His own mercy

202 Riding in that boat, the Lord came to Pāṇihāṭi, and He clothed the boatman in the cloth of His own mercy.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Pāṇihāṭī is the village of Pāṇihāṭī on the bank of the Gaṅgā, not far from the *śrīpāṭa* of Khaḍadaha.

Crowds gather at the Lord's arrival —

প্রভু আইলা বলি' লোকে হৈল কোলাহল ।
মনুষ্য ভরিল সব, কিবা জল, স্থল ॥ ২০৩ ॥

prabhu āilā bali' loke haila kolāhala
the Lord has come saying among the people arose an uproar
manuṣya bharila saba, kibā jala, sthala
with people filled everything whether water land

203 At the news that the Lord had come a great clamour arose, and land and water alike were filled with people.

Because of the crowds Rāghava brings the Lord to his home with great

difficulty —[12]

রাঘব-পণ্ডিত আসি' প্রভু লঞা গেলা ।
পথে যাইতে লোকভিড়ে কষ্টে-সৃষ্ট্যে আইলা ॥ ২০৪ ॥

rāghava-paṇḍita āsi' prabhu lañā gelā
Rāghava Paṇḍita coming the Lord taking went
pathe yāite loka-bhiḍe kaṣṭe-sṛṣṭye āilā
on the way going in the crowd with great difficulty they came

204 Rāghava Paṇḍita came and took the Lord with him, but because of the crowds on the way they got there only with great difficulty.

After staying one day in Rāghava's house, the Lord comes to Kumārahaṭṭa, to Śrīvāsa's house —

একদিন প্রভু তথা করিয়া নিবাস ।
প্রাতে কুমারহট্টে আইলা, — যাঁহা শ্রীনিবাস ॥ ২০৫ ॥

ekadina prabhu tathā kariyā nivāsa
one day the Lord there making stay
prāte kumārahaṭṭe āilā, — yāṁhā śrīnivāsa
in the morning to Kumārahaṭṭa He came where Śrīnivāsa

205 The Lord stayed there one day, and in the morning He came to Kumārahaṭṭa, where Śrīnivāsa lived.

Then, close by, He comes first to Śivānanda's house and afterwards to Vāsudeva's —

তাঁহা হৈতে আগে গেলা শিবানন্দ-ঘর ।
বাসুদেব-গৃহে পাছে আইলা ঈশ্বর ॥ ২০৬ ॥

tāṁhā haite āge gelā śivānanda-ghara
from there next He went to Śivānanda's house
vāsudeva-gṛhe pāche āilā īśvara
to Vāsudeva's house afterwards came the Lord

206 From there He went on to Śivānanda's house, and after that the Lord came to the house of Vāsudeva.

Next the Lord comes to Vidyānagara, to the house of Vidyā-vācaspati, and, seeing the huge crowds, goes secretly to Kuliyā —

'বাচস্পতি-গৃহে' প্রভু যেমতে রহিলা ।
লোক-ভিড়-ভয়ে যৈছে 'কুলিয়া' আইলা ॥ ২০৭ ॥

'vācaspati-gṛhe' prabhu yemate rahilā
in Vācaspati's house the Lord how stayed
loka-bhiḍa-bhaye yaiche 'kuliyā' āilā
for fear of the crowds how to Kuliyā He came

207 Then the Lord stayed in Vācaspati's house, and for fear of the crowds He went on to Kuliyā.

Anubhāṣya.

The Lord stayed five days in Vācaspati's house — see Madhya 1.151.

Vācaspati's house was in "Vidyānagara," within Jahnu-dvīpa, near Koladvīpa; Devānanda Paṇḍita lived there — see *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya 21 and Antya 3.

Kuliyā. In the *Śrī Caitanya-candrodaya-nāṭaka*, Act 9 (the words spoken to the king by the men whom Rāya had sent and who returned from Navadvīpa to Kaṭaka): "Then He came to Kumārahaṭṭa, to the house of Śrīvāsa Paṇḍita. *** Then He came to Advaita's house, where Haridāsa greeted Him, and likewise, by the river route, He landed across from Navadvīpa, in the village named Kuliyā, at the house of Mādhava dāsa.** Having stayed there seven days in this way, He set out again along the bank." In the *Śrī Caitanya-carita-mahākāvya*: "On the next day the beautiful Lord came to a certain place on the western bank of the Gaṅgā, across from the land of Śrī Navadvīpa, and with His whole form gave full joy to the eyes of all living beings." *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya 3: "With all His associates Śrī Gaurasundara came unexpectedly and stayed at his (Vidyā-vācaspati's) house. In Navadvīpa and all around the news spread: 'The crest-jewel of *sannyāsīs* has come to Vācaspati's house!' Countless multitudes, crying 'Hari! Hari!', set out to see Gaurāṅga Śrī Hari. In the crowd no one could find a path; breaking the branches of the forest, people went in every direction. Wherever there

was forest, the crowd passed through it, and in a moment it all became fine roads. In a moment all the people reached the ferry, and the ferrymen did not know how to take them across. Vācaspati Mahāśaya came quickly and gathered many boats. But no one waited for the boats any more; they crossed in various ways, each as he could. In this way everyone crossed the Gaṅgā, and all of them clasped Vācaspati's feet. **The Lord went secretly to the town of Kuliyā — the Lord of Vaikuṇṭha came to Kuliyā.** All the people, crying 'Hari,' at once set out with Vācaspati in great delight. 'The jewel of *sannyāsīs* has come to the town of Kuliyā!' — at that moment a great cry rose on every side. Between Nadīyā and Kuliyā there is only the Gaṅgā: as soon as they heard, all the people ran there in great joy. However great the crowds had been in Vācaspati's village (Vidyānagara), millions of times more now filled the whole place. Hundreds of thousands of boats came from who knows where; I do not know how many crossed, and in how many ways. Hundreds of thousands of people floated in the waters of the Jāhnavī, all crossing in great eagerness. Having crossed the Gaṅgā on their own, they all embraced one another and raised the cry of Hari. In a moment the village of Kuliyā — the town and the fields around it — was so full that no space was left. In a moment Vācaspati Mahāśaya came, but he could not find where the Lord was staying. ** All the sinners there were when the Lord revealed Himself in Kuliyā — the high, the middling and the low — were all delivered. When Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya came to the village of Kuliyā, there was no one whom the Lord did not bless."

Nityānanda Prabhu's *saṅkīrtana* with His associates while He lived in Navadvīpa (*Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya 6): "Khānāyoḍā, Baḍagāchi and Do-gāchiyā; at times He crosses the Gaṅgā to Kuliyā." In the *Caitanya-maṅgala*: "After bathing in the Gaṅgā, the Lord went through Rāḍha-deśa and in due course arrived at the town of Kuliyā. At His mother's word He went again to Navadvīpa — to Bārakoṇā Ghāṭa, near His own house." Premadāsa: "In the midst of Nadīyā, as everyone knows, is a place called 'Kuliyā-Pāhāḍapura.'" In the *Bhakti-ratnākara* of Śrī Narahari Cakravartī, or Ghanaśyāma dāsa (wave 12): "Look, Śrīnivāsa, at Kuliyā Pāhāḍapura; formerly it was known as 'Koladvīpa-parvata.'" In his *Navadvīpa-parikramā*: "The village of Kuliyā-Pāhāḍapura; formerly it was called Koladvīpa-parvata." What was Kuliyā is the place still known as "Bāhir-dvīpa" — the present town of Navadvīpa — together with Koler Gañj, Kola-āmāda, Koler Daha, Gadakhāli and other places. Therefore the village that in recent times has been fancied to be "Kuliyār Pāṭ" can by no means be the "ancient Kuliyā."

*In Kuliyā the Lord stays at Mādhava dāsa's house, and countless people receive His *darśana* —*

মাধবদাস-গৃহে তথা শচীর নন্দন ।
লক্ষ-কোটী লোক তথা পাইল দর্শন ॥ ২০৮ ॥

mādhava-dāsa-gṛhe tathā śacīra nandana
in Mādhava dāsa's house there of Śacī the son
lakṣa-koṭī loka tathā pāila darśana
hundreds of thousands and millions people there obtained darśana

208 In Kuliyā the son of Śacī lodged in the house of Mādhava dāsa, and countless millions of people had His *darśana*.

Anubhāṣya.

Mādhava dāsa. Yudhiṣṭhira Caṭṭopādhyāya was born in the family of Śrīkara Caṭṭopādhyāya. He and his kinsmen moved from the village of Bilva-grāma and from Pāṭuli to "Kuliyā-Pāhāḍapura," or "Pāḍapura," within Navadvīpa. Yudhiṣṭhira's eldest son was Mādhava dāsa, the middle one Haridāsa, and the youngest Kṛṣṇasampati Caṭṭopādhyāya; their everyday names were "Chakaḍi," "Tinakaḍi" and "Dukaḍi" respectively. The descendants of Mādhava dāsa's grandson Vaṁśīvadana, and of his grandson Rāmacandra and others, live to this day in Bāghnāpāḍā, Baiṁci and other places.

*The Lord delivered many offenders in Kuliyā, so Kuliyā is "the *pāṭa* of Aparādha-bhañjana," the place where offences were forgiven —*

সাত দিন রহি' তথা লোক নিস্তারিলা ।
সব অপরাধিগণে প্রকারে তারিলা ॥ ২০৯ ॥

sāta dina rahi' tathā loka nistārilā
seven days staying there the people He delivered
saba aparādhi-gaṇe prakāre tārilā
all the offenders in His own way He saved

209 He stayed there seven days and delivered the people; in His own way He saved even all the offenders.

Anubhāṣya.

See Madhya 1.153–154.

The Lord goes to Advaita's house and meets Śacī —

‘শান্তিপুরাচার্য্য’-গৃহে ঐছে আইলা ।
শচী-মাতা মিলি’ তাঁর দুঃখ খণ্ডাইলা ॥ ২১০ ॥

‘śāntipurācārya’-gṛhe aiche āilā
to the house of the Ācārya of Śāntipura in the same way He came
śacī-mātā mili’ tāṁra duḥkha khaṇḍāilā
Mother Śacī meeting her sorrow He dispelled

210 In the same way He came to the house of the Ācārya of Śāntipura, and meeting Mother Śacī, He dispelled her sorrow.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The present name of Kumārahaṭṭa is “Hālisahara.” Soon after Mahāprabhu took *sannyāsa*, Śrīvāsa Paṇḍita left his home in Navadvīpa and built a house in Kumārahaṭṭa. From Kumārahaṭṭa the Lord went to Kāñcanapallī, that is, to Kāñcaḍāpāḍā, to the house of Śivānanda Sena, and then to the house of Vāsudeva Datta, near Śivānanda's house. From there the Lord went to Śrī Vidyānagara on the western bank of Śrī Navadvīpa. (Because of the crowds) He came from Vidyānagara to the village of Kuliyā and stayed in the house of Mādhava dāsa. Staying there seven days, He freed Devānanda and others from their offences. Because Kavirāja Gosvāmī mentions here the Lord's coming in this way to the house of the Ācārya of Śāntipura, many people suspect that there must be some “Kuliyā” near Kāñcaḍāpāḍā. One may surmise that this false notion gave rise to some “new Kuliyār Pāṭ.” In fact Mahāprabhu went to the house of the Ācārya of Śāntipura straight from Vāsudeva's house. That from there He went to the other (western) bank of Navadvīpa — to Vidyānagara, to the house of Vidyā-vācaspati, and to the village of Kuliyā — is clearly described in the *Śrī Caitanya-bhāgavata*, the *Śrī Caitanya-maṅgala*, the *Śrī Caitanya-candrodaya-nāṭaka*, Premadāsa's Bengali rendering, and the *Śrī Caitanya-carita-kāvya*. Śrī Kavirāja Gosvāmī did not describe this journey in order, and this is the root of all these disturbances and doubts.

The Lord comes to Rāmakeli and returns from “Kānāir Nāṭaśālā” to Śāntipura

—

তবে ‘রামকেলি’-গ্রামে প্রভু যৈছে গেলা ।
‘নাটশালা’ হৈতে প্রভু পুনঃ ফিরি’ আইলা ॥ ২১১ ॥

tabe ‘rāmakeli’-grāme prabhu yaiche gelā
then to the village of Rāmakeli the Lord how went
‘nāṭaśālā’ haite prabhu punaḥ phiri’ āilā
Nāṭaśālā from the Lord again turning back came

211 Then the Lord went to the village of Rāmakeli, and from Nāṭaśālā He turned back once again.

Anubhāṣya.
For the Lord's coming to Rāmakeli to see Śrī Rūpa and Sanātana, His meeting and conversation with them, see Madhya 1.166–226; for His going to “Kānāir Nāṭaśālā,” see Madhya 1.227–231.

শান্তিপুরে পুনঃ কৈল দশ-দিন বাস ।
বিস্তারি’ বর্ণিয়াছেন বৃন্দাবন দাস ॥ ২১২ ॥

śāntipure punaḥ kaila daśa-dina vāsa
in Śāntipura again He made a ten days’ stay
vistāri’ varṇiyāchena vṛndāvana dāsa
in detail has described Vṛndāvana dāsa

212 In Śāntipura He stayed again for ten days. Vṛndāvana dāsa has described this in detail.[7]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
See the *Śrī Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya-khaṇḍa, chapter 3.

Anubhāṣya.
The ten days in Śāntipura: see Madhya 1.232–233.

Many events have already been described in the summary of chapter 1, so the

author, fearing prolixity, does not describe them again —

অতএব ইঁহা তার না কৈলুঁ বিস্তার ।
পুনরুক্তি হয়, গ্রন্থ বাড়য়ে অপার ॥ ২১৩ ॥

ataeva iṁhā tāra nā kailuṁ vistāra
therefore here of it not I have made elaboration
punarukti haya, grantha bāḍaye apāra
repetition it is the book grows without limit

213 Therefore I have not described it at length here: it would be a repetition, and the book would grow endlessly.

তার মধ্যে মিলিলা যৈছে রূপ-সনাতন ।
নৃসিংহানন্দ কৈল যৈছে পথের সাজন ॥ ২১৪ ॥

tāra madhye mililā yaiche rūpa-sanātana
that within met how Rūpa and Sanātana
nṛsiṁhānanda kaila yaiche pathera sājana
Nṛsiṁhānanda made how of the road the decoration

214 Among these events are how Rūpa and Sanātana met Him, and how Nṛsiṁhānanda decorated the road for Him.

সূত্রমধ্যে সেই লীলা আমি ত' বর্ণিলুঁ ।
অতএব পুনঃ তাহা ইহাঁ না লিখিলুঁ ॥ ২১৫ ॥

sūtra-madhye sei līlā āmi ta' varṇiluṁ
in the summary that pastime I indeed have described
ataeva punaḥ tāhā ihāṁ nā likhiluṁ
therefore again it here not I have written

215 I have already described these pastimes in the summary, so I have not written of them here again.

Anubhāṣya.
Nṛsiṁhānanda: see Ādi 10.35 and Madhya 1.155–162.

In Śāntipura Śrī Raghunātha meets the Lord —

পুনরপি প্রভু যদি ‘শান্তিপুর’ আইলা ।
রঘুনাথ-দাস আসি’ প্রভুরে মিলিলা ॥ ২১৬ ॥

punarapi prabhu yadi ‘śāntipura’ āilā
once again the Lord when to Śāntipura came
raghunātha-dāsa āsi’ prabhure mililā
Raghunātha dāsa coming the Lord met

216 When the Lord came to Śāntipura once again, Raghunātha dāsa came and met Him.

Śrī Raghunātha's father and uncle —

‘হিরণ্য’, ‘গোবর্দ্ধন’, — দুই সহোদর ।
সপ্তগ্রামে বারলক্ষ মুদ্রার ঈশ্বর ॥ ২১৭ ॥

‘hiraṇya’, ‘govardhana’, — dui sahodara
Hiraṇya Govardhana two brothers
saptagrāme bāra-lakṣa mudrāra īśvara
in Saptagrāma twelve lakhs of coins the masters

217 Hiraṇya and Govardhana were two brothers, masters of twelve lakhs of coins in Saptagrāma.

Anubhāṣya.

Hiraṇya and Govardhana were two brothers of a Kāyastha family by birth, residents of the village of Śrī Kṛṣṇapura near Saptagrāma in Hugalī district. Their family title is not known for certain, but they were *sat-kulīna* (of a noble family). The elder was named Hiraṇya Majumadāra and the younger Govardhana Majumadāra. Govardhana's son was Śrī Raghunātha dāsa. Their *purohita* (family priest) was Balarāma Ācārya, who received the mercy of Śrī Haridāsa Ṭhākura (Antya 3.165–166), and their *guru-purohita* was Yadunandana Ācārya, who received the mercy of Śrī Vāsudeva Datta (Antya 6.161). For other facts about them see Antya 3.165, 171–174, 188–189, 198, 201 and 206, and Antya 6.17–34, 37–40. For the Lord's own description of their conduct, see Antya 6.195–198.

Saptagrāma is an ancient port and town on the bank of the Sarasvatī river, near Triśabighā railway station on the E.I.R. line, in Hugalī district. In 1592 the Pathans plundered it, and in 1632, when the Sarasvatī's current was blocked, this very ancient port was all but ruined. It is said that even in the seventeenth and eighteenth centuries Portuguese sailors came here by ship to trade. In the southern Bengal of those days Saptagrāma was famous as a prominent and prosperous town. Here lived the two brothers Hiraṇya and Govardhana, masters of enormous wealth. At that time they collected twelve *lakhs* of coins in revenue each year. See the first part of the *Anubhāṣya* on Ādi 11.41, on Uddhāraṇa Datta.

মহৈশ্বর্য্যযুক্ত দুঁহে — বদান্য, ব্রহ্মণ্য ।
সদাচারী, সৎকুলীন, ধার্ম্মিকাগ্রগণ্য ॥ ২১৮ ॥

mahaiśvarya-yukta duṁhe — vadānya, brahmaṇya
endowed with great wealth both generous devoted to brāhmaṇas
sadācārī, satkulīna, dhārmikāgra-gaṇya
of good conduct of noble family counted foremost among the righteous

218 Both were immensely wealthy, generous and devoted to brāhmaṇas; they were men of good conduct and noble family, counted foremost among the righteous.

নদীয়া-বাসী ব্রাহ্মণের উপজীব্য-প্রায় ।
অর্থ, ভূমি, গ্রাম দিয়া করেন সহায় ॥ ২১৯ ॥

nadīyā-vāsī brāhmaṇera upajīvya-prāya
living in Nadīyā of the brāhmaṇas the means of livelihood almost
artha, bhūmi, grāma diyā karena sahāya
money land villages giving they give help

219 They were, as it were, the livelihood of the brāhmaṇas of Nadīyā, helping them with gifts of money, land and villages.

Anubhāṣya.
Although in Śrī Māhāprabhu's time Navadvīpa was a wealthy town, it was simply the home of *brāhmaṇas* devoted to learning, who depended on Hiraṇya and Govardhana. These pure *brāhmaṇas* lived under the brothers' care: with the

money, land, villages and so on that Hiraṇya and Govardhana gave them, they taught and supported themselves. The brothers held *brāhmaṇas* in extraordinary esteem and never hesitated to give to them with an open hand.

How their acquaintance with the Lord began —

নীলাম্বর চক্রবর্তী — আরাধ্য দুঁহার ।
চক্রবর্তী করে দুঁহায় 'ভ্রাতৃ'-ব্যবহার ॥ ২২০ ॥

nīlāmbara cakravartī — ārādhya duṁhāra
Nīlāmbara Cakravartī worshipful of both
cakravartī kare duṁhāya 'bhrātṛ'-vyavahāra
the Cakravartī shows to both a brother's dealings

220 Nīlāmbara Cakravartī was revered by both of them, and the Cakravartī treated them as his brothers.

মিশ্র-পুরন্দরের পূর্ব্বে কর্য্যাছেন সেবনে ।
অতএব প্রভু ভাল জানে দুইজনে ॥ ২২১ ॥

miśra-purandarera pūrve karyāchena sevane
to Miśra Purandara formerly they had done service
ataeva prabhu bhāla jāne dui-jane
therefore the Lord well knows the two

221 In the past they had served Miśra Purandara, and so the Lord knew them both well.

Who Śrī Raghunātha was —

সেই গোবর্দ্ধনের পুত্র — রঘুনাথ দাস ।
বাল্যকাল হৈতে তেঁহো বিষয়ে উদাস ॥ ২২২ ॥

sei govardhanera putra — raghunātha dāsa
that Govardhana's son Raghunātha dāsa
bālya-kāla haite teṁho viṣaye udāsa
childhood from he to worldly things indifferent

222 Raghunātha dāsa was the son of that Govardhana. From childhood he was indifferent to worldly things.

In Śāntipura Raghu sees the Lord's feet —

সন্ন্যাস করি’ প্রভু যবে শান্তিপুর আইলা ।
তবে আসি’ রঘুনাথ প্রভুরে মিলিলা ॥ ২২৩ ॥

sannyāsa kari’ prabhu yabe śāntipura āilā
sannyāsa taking the Lord when to Śāntipura came
tabe āsi’ raghunātha prabhure mililā
then coming Raghunātha the Lord met

223 When the Lord came to Śāntipura after taking *sannyāsa*, Raghunātha had come and met Him.

Raghu takes shelter at the Lord's feet —

প্রভুর চরণে পড়ে প্রেমাবিষ্ট হঞা ।
প্রভু পাদস্পর্শ কৈল করুণা করিয়া ॥ ২২৪ ॥

prabhura caraṇe paḍe premāviṣṭa hañā
the Lord’s at the feet he falls absorbed in love becoming
prabhu pāda-sparśa kaila karuṇā kariyā
the Lord the touch of His foot gave mercy showing

224 Absorbed in love, he fell at the Lord’s feet, and the Lord mercifully touched him with His foot.

By the mercy of Advaita, who loved him for his father's sake, Raghu gains the Lord's company —

তাঁর পিতা সদা করে আচার্য্য-সেবন ।
অতএব আচার্য্য তাঁরে হৈলা পরসন্ন ॥ ২২৫ ॥

tāṁra pitā sadā kare ācārya-sevana
his father always does service to the Ācārya
ataeva ācārya tāṁre hailā parasanna
therefore the Ācārya to him became gracious

225 His father always served the Ācārya, and so the Ācārya was gracious to him.

আচার্য্য-প্রসাদে পাইল প্রভুর উচ্ছিষ্ট-পাত ।
প্রভুর চরণ দেখে দিন পাঁচ-সাত ॥ ২২৬ ॥

ācārya-prasāde pāila prabhura ucchiṣṭa-pāta
by the Ācārya's grace he obtained the Lord's plate of remnants
prabhura caraṇa dekhe dina pāṁca-sāta
the Lord's feet he sees days five or seven

226 By the Ācārya's grace he received the Lord's plate of remnants, and for five or seven days he saw the Lord's feet.

Parted from the Lord, Raghu goes mad with separation from Him —

প্রভু তাঁরে বিদায় দিয়া গেলা নীলাচল ।
তেঁহো ঘরে আসি' হৈলা প্রেমেতে পাগল ॥ ২২৭ ॥

prabhu tāṁre vidāya diyā gelā nīlācala
the Lord him leave giving went to Nīlācala
teṁho ghare āsi' hailā premete pāgala
he home coming became with love mad

227 The Lord bade him farewell and went to Nīlācala, and he came home mad with love.

Before this he had tried again and again to run away, and his father kept him under guard —

বার বার পলায় তেঁহো নীলাদ্রি যাইতে ।
পিতা তাঁরে বান্ধি' রাখে, আনি' পথ হৈতে ॥ ২২৮ ॥

bāra bāra palāya teṁho nīlādri yāite
time and again runs away he to Nīlādri to go
pitā tāṁre bāndhi' rākhe, āni' patha haite
the father him binding keeps bringing back the road from

228 Again and again he ran away to go to Nīlādri, and his father would bring him back from the road and keep him bound.

Eleven guards are set over him, and he grieves at being unable to see the Lord

—

পঞ্চ পাইক তাঁরে রাখে রাত্রি-দিনে ।
চারি সেবক, দুই ব্রাহ্মণ রহে তাঁর সনে ॥ ২২৯ ॥

pañca pāika tāṁre rākhe rātri-dine
five guards him keep night and day
cāri sevaka, dui brāhmaṇa rahe tāṁra sane
four servants two brāhmaṇas stay him with

229 Five guards watched him night and day, and four servants and two brāhmaṇas stayed with him.

একাদশ জন তাঁরে রাখে নিরন্তর ।
নীলাচলে যাইতে না পায়, দুঃখিত অন্তর ॥ ২৩০ ॥

ekādaśa jana tāṁre rākhe nirantara
eleven people him keep constantly
nīlācale yāite nā pāya, duḥkhita antara
to Nīlācala to go not he is able sorrowful heart

230 Eleven people guarded him constantly. He could not go to Nīlācala, and his heart was full of sorrow.

Now, as soon as the Lord comes to Śāntipura, Raghu asks his father to let him

go and see the Lord —[13]

এবে যদি মহাপ্রভু 'শান্তিপুর' আইলা ।
শুনিয়া পিতারে রঘুনাথ নিবেদিলা ॥ ২৩১ ॥

ebe yadi mahāprabhu 'śāntipura' āilā
now when Mahāprabhu to Śāntipura came
śuniyā pitāre raghunātha nivedilā
hearing to his father Raghunātha submitted

231 Now, hearing that Mahāprabhu had come to Śāntipura, Raghunātha humbly said to his father,

আজ্ঞা দেহ', যাঞা দেখি প্রভুর চরণ ।
অন্যথা, না রহে মোর শরীরে জীবন ॥ ২৩২ ॥

ājñā deha', yāñā dekhi prabhura caraṇa
permission give going let me see the Lord's feet
anyathā, nā rahe mora śarīre jīvana
otherwise not remains my in the body life

232 "Give me leave to go and see the Lord's feet; otherwise my life will not stay in my body."

The father sends his son to the Lord —

শুনি' তাঁর পিতা বহু লোক-দ্রব্য দিয়া ।
পাঠাইল বলি' 'শীঘ্র আসিহ ফিরিয়া' ॥ ২৩৩ ॥

śuni' tāṁra pitā bahu loka-dravya diyā
hearing his father many men and goods giving
pāṭhāila bali' 'śīghra āsiha phiriyā'
sent him saying quickly come returning

233 Hearing this, his father gave him many men and provisions and sent him off, saying, "Come back quickly."[8]

Having come to Śāntipura, he wonders how to get free of the guards —

সাত দিন শান্তিপুরে প্রভুসঙ্গে রহে ।
রাত্রি-দিবসে এই মনঃকথা কহে ॥ ২৩৪ ॥

sāta dina śāntipure prabhusaṅge rahe
seven days in Śāntipura with the Lord he stays
rātri-divase ei manaḥ-kathā kahe
night and day this thought of the heart he speaks

234 For seven days he stayed with the Lord in Śāntipura, and night and day he poured out the one thought of his heart:

রক্ষকের হাতে মুঞি কেমনে ছুটিব !
কেমনে প্রভুর সঙ্গে নীলাচলে যাব ? ॥ ২৩৫ ॥

rakṣakera hāte muñi kemane chuṭiba!
of the guards from the hands I how shall escape
kemane prabhura saṅge nīlācale yāba?
how the Lord's with to Nīlācala shall I go

235 "How shall I escape from the hands of my guards? How shall I go to Nīlācala with the Lord?"

The Lord instructs Raghunātha, who is playing the role of a conditioned soul —

সর্ব্বজ্ঞ গৌরাঙ্গপ্রভু জানি' তাঁর মন ।
শিক্ষা-রূপে কহে তাঁরে আশ্বাস-বচন ॥ ২৩৬ ॥

sarvajña gaurāṅga-prabhu jāni' tāṁra mana
omniscient Lord Gaurāṅga knowing his mind
śikṣā-rūpe kahe tāṁre āśvāsa-vacana
as instruction speaks to him words of comfort

236 The omniscient Lord Gaurāṅga knew his mind, and He comforted him with these words of instruction:

*The Lord tells him to accept *yukta-vairāgya* (true renunciation) and give up *phalgu-vairāgya* (false renunciation) —*

স্থির হঞা ঘরে যাও, না হও বাতুল ।
ক্রমে ক্রমে পায় লোক ভবসিন্ধুকূল ॥ ২৩৭ ॥

sthira hañā ghare yāo, nā hao vātula
steady becoming home go not be mad
krame krame pāya loka bhava-sindhu-kūla
step by step reaches a person the shore of the ocean of material existence

237 "Be steady and go home; do not act like a madman. Step by step a person reaches the shore of the ocean of material existence.

মর্কট-বৈরাগ্য না কর লোক দেখাঞা ।
যথাযোগ্য বিষয় ভুঞ্জ' অনাসক্ত হঞা ॥ ২৩৮ ॥

markaṭa-vairāgya nā kara loka dekhāñā
monkey renunciation not practise people showing
yathā-yogya viṣaya bhuñja' anāsakta hañā
as befits worldly things accept unattached becoming

238 Do not make a show of monkey renunciation (*markaṭa-vairāgya*) for people to see. Accept worldly things as is fitting, but without attachment.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Markaṭa-vairāgya (monkey renunciation). Thoughts of sense objects in the heart and secret relations with women, while outwardly wearing a *kaupīna*, an outer cloth (*bahirvāsa*) and the other marks of renunciation — all these are the signs of a "*markaṭa-vairāgī*."

Anubhāṣya.

Markaṭa-vairāgya (monkey renunciation). Monkeys, though bent on enjoyment, seem to live without houses or clothes, and so they may be taken as the "equals" of men endowed with detachment; yet they never stop gratifying their senses. Such renunciation "for show" is called *markaṭa-vairāgya*. There is a renunciation that does not arise from pure *bhakti*, born together with it, but springs from the frustration of desires or longings for things other than Kṛṣṇa. It does not remain for

life as a support of pure *bhakti* but proves “momentary,” or *phalgu*; this is *śmaśāna-vairāgya* (cremation-ground renunciation), or *markaṭa-vairāgya*. But if a person, for the sake of service to Kṛṣṇa, merely accepts what is strictly unavoidable among worldly things and lives without absorption in them, he does not fall under the sway of the fruits of *karma*. The words of the *Nārada Purāṇa* cited in the *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu* (Pūrva-vibhāga, 2nd Laharī): “One who knows the true goal should accept [worldly things] only as much as is needed to maintain himself. By taking more or less, he falls away from the highest goal.” In his commentary *Durgama-saṅgamanī* Śrī Jīva Prabhu explains the word *sva-nirvāhaḥ* (“maintaining oneself”) in this verse as *sva-sva-bhakti-nirvāhaḥ*, “maintaining one's own *bhakti*.” Further, in the *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu* (Pūrva-vibhāga, 2nd Laharī, 125 and 126),[14] on *phalgu-vairāgya*: “When those who seek liberation reject things connected with Hari, regarding them as worldly, that renunciation is called *phalgu* (worthless).” That is: “To reject as ‘worldly’ what is favourable to service of Śrī Hari is a mistake.” On *yukta-vairāgya*: “When one uses worldly things as is fitting, without attachment, and holds firmly to their connection with Kṛṣṇa, that is called *yukta-vairāgya*.” That is: “Worldly things, free of attachment and in their connection [with Kṛṣṇa], are all Mādhava.”

অন্তরে নিষ্ঠা কর, বাহ্যে লোক ব্যবহার ।
অচিরাৎ কৃষ্ণ তোমায় করিবে উদ্ধার ॥ ২৩৯ ॥

antare niṣṭhā kara, bāhye loka vyavahāra
within firm faith keep outwardly worldly conduct
acirāt kṛṣṇa tomāya karibe uddhāra
very soon Kṛṣṇa you will make deliverance

239 Keep firm faith within, and outwardly behave as people do in the world. Very soon Kṛṣṇa will deliver you.

Anubhāṣya.

Show people the conduct that society ordinarily considers proper, while in your heart you give up absorption in material things and, fixed in Me, serve Bhagavān with devotion. If you serve Kṛṣṇa in this way with a guileless heart, Kṛṣṇa Himself will free you from the bonds of *saṁsāra*. The words “Be steadfast within, and outwardly behave as people do” simply explain the earlier words “Enjoy worldly things as is fitting, without attachment.” *Niṣṭhā* means steadfastness in Kṛṣṇa,

that is, abiding resolutely in unmotivated cultivation of Kṛṣṇa, having given up desire and thirst for anything other than Kṛṣṇa. “Behave as people do”: the *Pañcarātra* text cited in the *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu* (Pūrva-vibhāga, 2nd Laharī): “One who desires *bhakti*, O sage, should perform only those acts, worldly or Vedic, that are favourable to service of Hari.”

The Lord tells him to come to Him when He has returned from Vṛndāvana and is staying in Nīlācala —

বৃন্দাবন দেখি’ যবে আসিব নীলাচলে ।
তবে তুমি আমা-পাশ আসিহ কোন ছলে ॥ ২৪০ ॥

vṛndāvana dekhi’ yabe āsiba nīlācale
Vṛndāvana having seen when I shall come to Nīlācala
tabe tumi āmā-pāśa āsiha kona chale
then you to Me come some on pretext

240 When I have seen Vṛndāvana and come back to Nīlācala, then come to Me on some pretext.

Only Kṛṣṇa's causeless mercy makes one fit to attain Kṛṣṇa —

সে ছল সেকালে কৃষ্ণ স্ফুরাবে তোমারে ।
কৃষ্ণকৃপা যাঁরে, তাঁরে কে রাখিতে পারে ॥ ২৪১ ॥

se chala se-kāle kṛṣṇa sphurābe tomāre
that pretext at that time Kṛṣṇa will reveal to you
kṛṣṇa-kṛpā yāṁre, tāṁre ke rākhite pāre
Kṛṣṇa’s mercy on whom him who to hold back can

241 At that time Kṛṣṇa Himself will show you that pretext. Who can hold back one who has Kṛṣṇa’s mercy?”

*Having taken leave of the Lord, he practises *yukta-vairāgya* at home —*

এত কহি’ মহাপ্রভু তাঁরে বিদায় দিল ।
ঘরে আসি’ মহাপ্রভুর শিক্ষা আচরিল ॥ ২৪২ ॥

eta kahi' mahāprabhu tāṁre vidāya dila
this saying Mahāprabhu him leave gave
ghare āsi' mahāprabhura śikṣā ācarila
home coming Mahāprabhu's teaching he practised

242 Saying this, Mahāprabhu bade him farewell, and he went home and followed the Lord's teaching.

বাহ্য বৈরাগ্য বাতুলতা সকল ছাড়িয়া ।
যথাযোগ্য কার্য্য করে অনাসক্ত হঞা ॥ ২৪৩ ॥

bāhya vairāgya vātulatā sakala chāḍiyā
outward renunciation madness all giving up
yathā-yogya kārya kare anāsakta hañā
as befits duties he does unattached becoming

243 Giving up all his outward renunciation and madness, he did his duties as was fitting, without attachment.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Raghunātha dāsa came back from Śāntipura to Saptagrāma and began to follow Mahāprabhu's teaching. He kept his renunciation within his heart; outwardly he no longer showed any renunciation or madness, and without attachment he took up the household duties that befitted him.

Anubhāṣya.
He gave up the madness in which, before people's eyes, he had refused to accept anything worldly, and without attachment began to carry out suitable duties in a way favourable to service of Kṛṣṇa.

His parents rejoice at Raghunātha's conduct, and the guard around him slackens —

দেখি' তাঁর পিতা-মাতা বড় সুখ পাইল ।
তাঁহার আবরণ কিছু শিথিল হইল ॥ ২৪৪ ॥

dekhi' tāṁra pitā-mātā baḍa sukha pāila
seeing his father and mother great happiness felt
tāṁhāra āvaraṇa kichu śithila haila
his guard somewhat slack became

244 Seeing this, his father and mother were very happy, and the watch over him was somewhat relaxed.

Anubhāṣya.
When his parents saw that Śrī Raghunātha's outward marks of renunciation had slackened, their hearts, inclined to family life, rejoiced greatly. They no longer thought it necessary to keep around Raghunātha a cordon (*veṣṭana*) of eleven people — five foot guards, four servants and two *brāhmaṇas*. Seeing him gradually take on responsibilities in the household, they reduced the number of guards.

Anubhāṣya.
See Antya 6.13–15.

The Lord asks Nitāi, Advaita and all the devotees for permission to go to Vṛndāvana by way of Purī —

ইহাঁ প্রভু একত্র করি' সব ভক্তগণ ।
অদ্বৈত-নিত্যানন্দাদি যত ভক্তজন ॥ ২৪৫ ॥

ihāṁ prabhu ekatra kari' saba bhakta-gaṇa
here the Lord together gathering all the devotees
advaita-nityānandādi yata bhakta-jana
Advaita, Nityānanda and others all the devotees

245 Meanwhile the Lord gathered all His devotees together, Advaita, Nityānanda and all the others,

সবা আলিঙ্গন করি' কহেন গোসাঞি ।
সবে আজ্ঞা দেহ' আমি নীলাচলে যাই ॥ ২৪৬ ॥

sabā āliṅgana kari' kahena gosāñi
everyone embrace making says Gosāñi
sabe ājñā deha' āmi nīlācale yāi
all permission give I to Nīlācala may go

246 and, embracing them all, Gosāñi said, "All of you, give Me leave to go to Nīlācala.

The Lord forbids everyone to come to Purī that year —

সবার সহিত ইঁহা আমার হইল মিলন ।
এ বর্ষ 'নীলাদ্রি' কেহ না করিহ গমন ॥ ২৪৭ ॥

sabāra sahita iṁhā āmāra haila milana
all with here My has been meeting
e varṣa 'nīlādri' keha nā kariha gamana
this year to Nīlādri anyone not make going

247 I have met all of you here. This year let no one go to Nīlādri.

তাঁহা হৈতে অবশ্য আমি 'বৃন্দাবন' যাব ।
সবে আজ্ঞা দেহ', তবে নির্ব্বিঘ্নে আসিব ॥ ২৪৮ ॥

tāṁhā haite avaśya āmi 'vṛndāvana' yāba
from there certainly I to Vṛndāvana shall go
sabe ājñā deha', tabe nirvighne āsiba
all permission give then without obstacles I shall return

248 From there I shall certainly go to Vṛndāvana. Give Me your leave, all of you, and then I shall come back without any obstacle."

The Lord humbly asks Śacī for permission —

মাতার চরণে ধরি' বহু বিনয় করিল ।
বৃন্দাবন যাইতে তাঁর আজ্ঞা লইল ॥ ২৪৯ ॥

mātāra caraṇe dhari' bahu vinaya karila
of His mother the feet clasping much humble entreaty He made
vṛndāvana yāite tāṁra ājñā laila
to Vṛndāvana to go her permission He took

249 Clasping His mother's feet, He entreated her humbly and received her permission to go to Vṛndāvana.

The Lord sends His mother from Śāntipura to Navadvīpa and sets out for Purī

—

তবে নবদ্বীপে তাঁরে দিল পাঠাঞা ।
নীলাদ্রি চলিলা সঙ্গে ভক্তগণ লঞা ॥ ২৫০ ॥

tabe navadvīpe tāṁre dila pāṭhāñā
then to Navadvīpa her He sent
nīlādri calilā saṅge bhakta-gaṇa lañā
to Nīlādri He set out with Him the devotees taking

250 Then He sent her back to Navadvīpa and set out for Nīlādri, taking the devotees with Him.

Arrival in Purī —

সেই সব লোক পথে করেন সেবন ।
সুখে নীলাচল আইলা শচীর নন্দন ॥ ২৫১ ॥

sei saba loka pathe karena sevana
those all people on the way do service
sukhe nīlācala āilā śacīra nandana
happily to Nīlācala came Śacī's son

251 All those people served Him along the way, and the son of Śacī came happily to Nīlācala.

**Darśana* of Jagannātha; the news of His return spreads everywhere —*

প্রভু আসি' জগন্নাথ দরশন কৈল ।
মহাপ্রভু আইলা — গ্রামে কোলাহল হৈল ॥ ২৫২ ॥

prabhu āsi' jagannātha daraśana kaila
the Lord coming Jagannātha darśana had
mahāprabhu āilā — grāme kolāhala haila
Mahāprabhu has come in the town an uproar arose

252 On arriving, the Lord went to see Jagannātha, and the town was in an uproar: "Mahāprabhu has come!"

The devotees meet the Lord —

আনন্দিত ভক্তগণ আসিয়া মিলিলা ।
প্রেম-আলিঙ্গন প্রভু সবারে করিলা ॥ ২৫৩ ॥

ānandita bhakta-gaṇa āsiyā mililā
delighted the devotees coming met Him
prema-āliṅgana prabhu sabāre karilā
loving embrace the Lord to all gave

253 The delighted devotees came to meet Him, and the Lord embraced them all with love.

কাশীমিশ্র, রামানন্দ, প্রদ্যুম্ন, সার্ব্বভৌম ।
বাণীনাথ, শিখি-আদি যত ভক্তগণ ॥ ২৫৪ ॥

kāśī-miśra, rāmānanda, pradyumna, sārvabhauma
Kāśī Miśra Rāmānanda Pradyumna Sārvabhauma
vāṇīnātha, śikhi-ādi yata bhakta-gaṇa
Vāṇīnātha Śikhi and others all the devotees

254 Kāśī Miśra, Rāmānanda, Pradyumna, Sārvabhauma, Vāṇīnātha, Śikhi and all the other devotees came.

The Lord tells everyone what had hindered His earlier journey to Vṛndāvana

—

গদাধর-পণ্ডিত আসি' প্রভুরে মিলিলা ।
সবার অগ্রেতে প্রভু কহিতে লাগিলা ॥ ২৫৫ ॥

gadādhara-paṇḍita āsi' prabhure mililā
Gadādhara Paṇḍita coming the Lord met
sabāra agrete prabhu kahite lāgilā
of all in front the Lord to speak began

255 Gadādhara Paṇḍita came and met the Lord, and in front of them all He began to speak:

বৃন্দাবন যাব আমি গৌড়দেশ দিয়া ।
নিজ-মাতার, গঙ্গার চরণ দেখিয়া ॥ ২৫৬ ॥

vṛndāvana yāba āmi gauḍa-deśa diyā
to Vṛndāvana shall go I the land of Gauḍa through
nija-mātāra, gaṅgāra caraṇa dekhiyā
My own mother's the Gaṅgā's feet seeing

256 "I thought, 'I shall go to Vṛndāvana through the land of Gauḍa, seeing on the way the feet of My mother and of the Gaṅgā.'

এত মতে করি' কৈলুঁ গৌড়েরে গমন ।
সহস্রেক সঙ্গে হৈল নিজ-ভক্তগণ ॥ ২৫৭ ॥

eta mate kari' kailuṁ gauḍere gamana
this way resolving I made to Gauḍa the journey
sahasreka saṅge haila nija-bhakta-gaṇa
about a thousand with Me were of My own devotees

257 With this resolve I set out for Gauḍa, and about a thousand of My own devotees came along with Me.

লক্ষ লক্ষ লোক আইসে কৌতুক দেখিতে ।
লোকের সংঘট্টে পথ না পারি চলিতে ॥ ২৫৮ ॥

lakṣa lakṣa loka āise kautuka dekhite
hundreds of thousands hundreds of thousands people come the spectacle to see
lokera saṅghaṭṭe patha nā pāri calite
of the people in the crush the road not I could travel

258 Hundreds of thousands of people came to see the spectacle, and in such a throng I could not travel the road.

যথা রহি, তথা ঘর-প্রাচীর হয় চূর্ণ ।
যথা নেত্র পড়ে, তথা লোক দেখি পূর্ণ ॥ ২৫৯ ॥

yathā rahi, tathā ghara-prācīra haya cūrṇa
where I stay there houses and walls are crushed
yathā netra paḍe, tathā loka dekhi pūrṇa
where the eye falls there with people I see full

259 Wherever I stayed, houses and walls were crushed; wherever My eyes fell, I saw the place filled with people.

Meeting Rūpa and Sanātana in the village of Rāmakeli, and an account of them

—

কষ্টে-সৃষ্ট্যে করি' গেলাঙ রামকেলি-গ্রাম ।
আমার ঠাঞি আইলা 'রূপ' 'সনাতন' নাম ॥ ২৬০ ॥

kaṣṭe-sṛṣṭye kari' gelāṅa rāmakeli-grāma
with great difficulty making I went to the village of Rāmakeli
āmāra ṭhāñi āilā 'rūpa' 'sanātana' nāma
to Me came Rūpa Sanātana named

260 With great difficulty I reached the village of Rāmakeli. There two men named Rūpa and Sanātana came to Me.

Anubhāṣya.

In the material world you are “the very best,” yet you consider yourselves “the lowest of all.” Therefore, although you are yourselves eternally perfect associates of Kṛṣṇa in Vraja, Kṛṣṇa will soon free you from this “bondage of *saṁsāra*” (?) and engage you in His eternal service: only to the external vision of worldly people, to knowledge gained through the senses, do you play the role of conditioned souls.[15]

দুই ভাই — ভক্তরাজ, কৃষ্ণকৃপা পাত্র ।
ব্যবহারে — রাজমন্ত্রী হয় রাজপাত্র ॥ ২৬১ ॥

dui bhāi — bhakta-rāja, kṛṣṇa-kṛpā pātra
two brothers kings of devotees of Kṛṣṇa’s mercy vessels
vyavahāre — rāja-mantrī haya rāja-pātra
in worldly affairs royal ministers are royal officers

261 The two brothers are kings among devotees, vessels of Kṛṣṇa’s mercy; in worldly affairs they are the king’s ministers and high officers.

বিদ্যা-ভক্তি-বুদ্ধি-বলে পরম প্রবীণ ।
তবু আপনাকে মানে তৃণ হৈতে হীন ॥ ২৬২ ॥

vidyā-bhakti-buddhi-bale parama pravīṇa
in learning, devotion, intelligence and strength supremely accomplished
tabu āpanāke māne tṛṇa haite hīna
still themselves they consider a blade of grass than lower

262 In learning, devotion, intelligence and strength they are supremely accomplished, yet they consider themselves lower than a blade of grass.

তাঁর দৈন্য দেখি’ শুনি’ পাষাণ বিদরে ।
আমি তুষ্ট হঞা তবে কহিলুঁ দোঁহারে ॥ ২৬৩ ॥

tāṁra dainya dekhi’ śuni’ pāṣāṇa vidare
their humility seeing hearing a stone splits
āmi tuṣṭa hañā tabe kahiluṁ doṁhāre
I pleased becoming then said to both

263 At the sight and sound of their humility even a stone would break. Pleased with them, I said to them both,

The Lord's instruction to Rūpa and Sanātana —

উত্তম হঞা হীন করি' মানহ আপনারে ।
অচিরে করিবে কৃষ্ণ তোমার উদ্ধারে ॥ ২৬৪ ॥

uttama hañā hīna kari' mānaha āpanāre
exalted being low as you consider yourselves
acire karibe kṛṣṇa tomāra uddhāre
soon will make Kṛṣṇa your deliverance

264 'Though you are exalted, you consider yourselves low. Kṛṣṇa will soon deliver you.'

At parting, Sanātana warns the Lord —

এত কহি' আমি যবে বিদায় তাঁরে দিল ।
গমনকালে সনাতন 'প্রহেলী' কহিল ॥ ২৬৫ ॥

eta kahi' āmi yabe vidāya tāṁre dila
this saying I when leave to them gave
gamana-kāle sanātana 'praheli' kahila
at the time of going Sanātana a riddle spoke

265 When I had said this and bade them farewell, Sanātana spoke a riddle as I was leaving:

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Praheli: a *prahelikā*, a riddle (*tarjā*).

It is not fitting to go to Vṛndāvana with a crowd of people who have all kinds of purposes —

যাঁর সঙ্গে হয় এই লোক লক্ষ, কোটি ।
বৃন্দাবন যাইবার এই নহে পরিপাটী ॥ ২৬৬ ॥

yāṁra saṅge haya ei loka lakṣa, koṭi
with whom along are these people hundreds of thousands millions
vṛndāvana yāibāra ei nahe paripāṭī
to Vṛndāvana of going this is not the proper way

266 'When hundreds of thousands, even millions of people go along with one, that is not the way to go to Vṛndāvana.'

Even so the Lord travels with the crowd; later, reflecting on Sanātana's words, He leaves it —[16]

তবু আমি শুনিলুঁ মাত্র, না কৈলুঁ অবধান ।
প্রাতে চলি' আইলাঙ 'কানাইর নাটশালা'-গ্রাম ॥ ২৬৭ ॥

tabu āmi śuniluṁ mātra, nā kailuṁ avadhāna
yet I heard only not I paid attention
prāte cali' āilāṅa 'kānāira nāṭaśālā'-grāma
in the morning traveling I came to the village of Kānāira Nāṭaśālā

267 Yet I only heard it and paid it no heed. In the morning I set out and came to the village of Kānāira Nāṭaśālā.

রাত্রিকালে মনে আমি বিচার করিল ।
সনাতন মোরে কিবা 'প্রহেলী' কহিল ॥ ২৬৮ ॥

rātri-kāle mane āmi vicāra karila
at night in My mind I consideration made
sanātana more kibā 'praheli' kahila
Sanātana to Me what riddle spoke

268 That night I pondered in My mind the riddle that Sanātana had told Me.

ভাল ত' কহিল, — মোর এত লোক সঙ্গে ।
লোক দেখি কহিবে মোরে — 'এই এক ঢঙ্গে' ॥ ২৬৯ ॥

bhāla ta' kahila, — mora eta loka saṅge
well indeed he spoke My so many people with Me
loka dekhi kahibe more — 'ei eka ḍhaṅge'
people seeing will say of Me "this is some show"

269 He spoke well. So many people are with Me that whoever sees it will say, 'This is just a show!'

*Vṛndāvana is the place of the most intimate *bhajana*: outsiders have no access to it, only the closest devotees who know its heart —*

'দুর্ল্লভ' 'দুর্গম' সেই 'নির্জ্জন' বৃন্দাবন ।
একাকী যাইব, কিবা সঙ্গে একজন ॥ ২৭০ ॥

'durlabha' 'durgama' sei 'nirjana' vṛndāvana
rare hard to reach that solitary Vṛndāvana
ekākī yāiba, kibā saṅge eka-jana
alone I shall go or with one person

270 That Vṛndāvana is rare, hard to reach and solitary. I shall go alone, or with just one companion.

*The great *mahājana* of former times, Mādhava Purī, went to Vṛndāvana alone —*

মাধবেন্দ্রপুরী তথা গেলা 'একেশ্বরে' ।
দুগ্ধদানছলে কৃষ্ণ-সাক্ষাৎ দিল তাঁরে ॥ ২৭১ ॥

mādhavendra-purī tathā gelā 'ekeśvare'
Mādhavendra Purī there went alone
dugdhadāna-chale kṛṣṇa-sākṣāt dila tāṁre
on the pretext of giving milk Kṛṣṇa His direct presence gave to him

271 Mādhavendra Purī went there alone, and on the pretext of bringing him milk, Kṛṣṇa appeared to him in person.

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 4.20–33, and also 172 and 179.

The Lord has no liking for large crowds —

বাদিয়ার বাজি পাতি' চলিলাঙ তথারে ৷
বহু-সঙ্গে বৃন্দাবন গমন না করে ॥ ২৭২ ॥

bādiyāra bāji pāti' calilāṅa tathāre
a juggler's show setting up I went there
bahu-saṅge vṛndāvana gamana nā kare
with a crowd to Vṛndāvana journey not one makes

272 I was travelling there like a juggler with his show. One does not go to Vṛndāvana with a crowd.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
When the *bādiyās*, that is, the *bedes* (itinerant conjurers), set up a place for their show, a crowd gathers. That I am going to Vṛndāvana with just such a crowd is not good.

একা যাইব, কিবা সঙ্গে ভৃত্য একজন ৷
তবে সে শোভয় বৃন্দাবনের গমন ॥ ২৭৩ ॥

ekā yāiba, kibā saṅge bhṛtya eka-jana
alone I shall go or with servant one
tabe se śobhaya vṛndāvanera gamana
then indeed is graceful to Vṛndāvana the going

273 I shall go alone, or with just one servant; only then is a journey to Vṛndāvana as it should be.

বৃন্দাবন যাব কাঁহা 'একাকী' হঞা !
সৈন্য সঙ্গে চলিয়াছি ঢাক বাজাঞা ! ॥ ২৭৪ ॥

vṛndāvana yāba kāṁhā 'ekākī' haña!
to Vṛndāvana I shall go where alone being
sainya saṅge caliyāchi ḍhāka bājāña!
an army with I have set out drums beating

274 I was to go to Vṛndāvana alone — and here I have set out with an army, beating drums!

Giving up the journey to Vṛndāvana, the Lord returns to the bank of the Gaṅgā —

ধিক্ ধিক্ আপনাকে বলি' হইলাঙ অস্থির ।
নিবৃত্ত হঞা পুনঃ আইলাঙ গঙ্গাতীর ॥ ২৭৫ ॥

dhik dhik āpanāke bali' hailāṅa asthira
shame shame to Myself saying I became restless
nivṛtta hañā punaḥ āilāṅa gaṅgā-tīra
turning back becoming again I came to the bank of the Gaṅgā

275 Saying 'Shame, shame on Me!', I grew restless, and turning back, I came again to the bank of the Gaṅgā.

The Lord comes to Purī with only a few devotees —[17]

ভক্তগণে রাখিয়া আইনু স্থানে-স্থানে ।
আমা-সঙ্গে আইলা সবে পাঁচ-ছয় জনে ॥ ২৭৬ ॥

bhakta-gaṇe rākhiyā āinu sthāne-sthāne
the devotees leaving I came in place after place
āmā-saṅge āilā sabe pāṁca-chaya jane
with Me came in all five or six persons

276 I left the devotees in their various places and came back; only five or six people came with Me.

The Lord asks everyone's advice on how to reach Vṛndāvana without hindrance —

নির্ব্বিঘ্নে এবে কৈছে যাইব বৃন্দাবনে ।
সবে মেলি' যুক্তি দেহ' হঞা পরসন্নে ॥ ২৭৭ ॥

nirvighne ebe kaiche yāiba vṛndāvane
without obstacles now how shall I go to Vṛndāvana
sabe meli' yukti deha' hañā parasanne
all together counsel give becoming gracious

277 Now, how am I to go to Vṛndāvana without obstacles? All of you together, be gracious and give Me your counsel.

The Lord lovingly consoles Gadādhara, who was grieved at being left behind —

গদাধরে ছাড়ি' গেনু, ইঁহো দুঃখ পাইল ।
সেই হেতু বৃন্দাবন যাইতে নারিল ॥ ২৭৮ ॥

gadādhare chāḍi' genu, iṁho duḥkha pāila
Gadādhara leaving I went he sorrow felt
sei hetu vṛndāvana yāite nārila
that for reason to Vṛndāvana to go I could not

278 I went away leaving Gadādhara behind, and he was grieved. For that reason I could not go to Vṛndāvana."

*The Paṇḍita, full of gentle (*dakṣiṇa*) feeling toward the Lord, speaks words of love and humility —*

তবে গদাধর-পণ্ডিত প্রেমাবিষ্ট হঞা ।
প্রভু-পদ ধরি' কহে বিনয় করিয়া ॥ ২৭৯ ॥

tabe gadādhara-paṇḍita premāviṣṭa hañā
then Gadādhara Paṇḍita absorbed in love becoming
prabhu-pada dhari' kahe vinaya kariyā
the Lord's feet clasping says humility showing

279 Then Gadādhara Paṇḍita, absorbed in love, clasped the Lord's feet and humbly said,

Wherever the Lord is, that place is Vṛndāvana; apart from Vṛndāvana there are

no sweet pastimes of Kṛṣṇa —

তুমি যাহাঁ-যাহাঁ রহ, তাহাঁ 'বৃন্দাবন' ।
তাহাঁ যমুনা, গঙ্গা, সর্ব্বতীর্থগণ ॥ ২৮০ ॥

tumi yāhāṁ-yāhāṁ raha, tāhāṁ 'vṛndāvana'
You wherever stay there is Vṛndāvana
tāhāṁ yamunā, gaṅgā, sarva-tīrtha-gaṇa
there the Yamunā the Gaṅgā all the holy places

280 "Wherever You stay, there is Vṛndāvana, and there are the Yamunā, the Gaṅgā and all the holy places.

The Lord goes to Vṛndāvana only to teach people —

তবু বৃন্দাবন যাহ' লোক শিখাইতে ।
সেইত করিবে, তোমার যেই লয় চিত্তে ॥ ২৮১ ॥

tabu vṛndāvana yāha' loka śikhāite
still to Vṛndāvana You go people to teach
seita karibe, tomāra yei laya citte
that very thing You will do Your which takes heart

281 Still, You go to Vṛndāvana to teach people. You will do just what Your heart decides.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrīman Mahāprabhu had already revealed His own mood among His associates while dancing before the chariot. Śrī Mahāprabhu's heart itself is Vṛndāvana, the land of Śrī Rādhākānta's pastimes. Even so, to teach people, He goes to the earthly (*bhauma*) Vṛndāvana manifested in the material world. Ordinary people, whose vision is mundane and who are intoxicated with sense enjoyment, think that the earthly Vṛndāvana is not transcendental: that it is a particular place like any other material land, which even senses bent on enjoyment can reach with the help of money, the means of enjoyment. Just as association with other such material things gives rise to material moods, so, if one goes to see "Vṛndāvana" (?) with the idea that it is an object of sense enjoyment, or with material intelligence, one gains no spiritual, eternal good — that is, service to Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the nondual Truth. This is proved by Śrī Mahāprabhu's words "My mind is Vṛndāvana" (Madhya 13.137) and

by the *Bhāgavatam* verse *āhuś ca te* (“They say that Your [lotus feet]…”).[18] (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.84.8)[19]: “One who takes this corpse-like body made of three elements for the self, who takes his wife and others for his own, who sees the object of worship in what is earthly and the holy place in water, but never in those who know the truth — he is like an ox or an ass.” In reality Mahāprabhu enacted the pastimes of travelling to Vṛndāvana, the Lord's transcendental place of pastimes, and of seeing it, only to teach materialistic people. If a conditioned soul forgets this and takes Vṛndāvana to be one of the “places of enjoyment” of the material world, he will be going against Mahāprabhu's teaching. The *prākṛta-sahajiyās* form their own idea of the holy *dhāma*, pride themselves on being “Vrajavāsīs” or “*dhāma-vāsīs*,” and proclaim it. In fact, instead of living in the spiritual Vṛndāvana, they live in dreadful *saṁsāra*, the field of their own sense gratification, and only multiply the rubbish. Pure *bhāgavatas* have no such mood or idea. Śrī Dāmodara Svarūpa is an eternal resident of Vraja, yet nothing is heard in his life of his going to the earthly Vṛndāvana. Nor does any book record such a journey by Śrī Puṇḍarīka Vidyānidhi, Śrī Haridāsa Ṭhākura, Śrīvāsa Paṇḍita, Śrī Śivānanda Sena, Śrī Rāmānanda Rāya, Śrī Śikhi Māhiti, Śrī Mādhavī Devī, Śrī Gadādhara Paṇḍita Gosvāmī and others. On the other hand, people commonly tell of many *prākṛta-sahajiyās*, *karmīs*, *jñānīs* and those with other desires — all devoid of pure *bhakti* — living in the earthly Vṛndāvana, seeing it or going there. Residence in the holy *dhāma* may give those without *bhakti* heaven or liberation, or the fruits that are won by sin, piety or renunciation; but only the pure devotee, endowed with the divine, spotless eyes meant in the verse *premāñjana-cchurita-bhakti-vilocanena* (“with eyes of devotion tinged with the salve of love”),[20] truly and really lives in the transcendental holy *dhāma* Vṛndāvana. In a later age Ṭhākura Narottama in the village of Kheturi and Śrīnivāsa Ācārya in the village of Yājigrāma, and in the age after them Śrī Jagannātha dāsa Bābājī Mahārāja in Gauḍa-deśa, Śrī Bhagavān dāsa in Kālnā, Śrīmad Gaurakiśora dāsa Bābājī Mahārāja in Navadvīpa-dhāma, Śrī Śrīmad Bhaktivinoda Ṭhākura in Calcutta and other devotees wholly devoted to the holy name certainly never lived in any *dhāma* other than Śrī Vṛndāvana.

The Lord is asked to spend the four months of the rains in Purī —

এই আগে আইলা, প্রভু, বর্ষার চারি মাস ।
এই চারি মাস কর নীলাচলে বাস ॥ ২৮২ ॥

ei āge āilā, prabhu, varṣāra cāri māsa
now ahead have come Lord of the rains four months
ei cāri māsa kara nīlācale vāsa
these four months make in Nīlācala residence

282 Lord, the four months of the rains are almost upon us. Spend these four months in Nīlācala.

After that the independent Lord may go wherever He likes: the devotees will not object —

পাছে সেই আচরিবা, যেই তোমার মন ।
আপন-ইচ্ছায় চল, রহ, — কে করে বারণ ॥ ২৮৩ ॥

pāche sei ācaribā, yei tomāra mana
afterwards that You will do which Your mind
āpana-icchāya cala, raha, — ke kare vāraṇa
by Your own will go stay who makes prohibition

283 Afterwards do whatever You have in mind. Go or stay as You please — who could stop You?"

This is the request of all the devotees —

শুনি' সব ভক্ত কহে প্রভুর চরণে ।
সবাকার ইচ্ছা পণ্ডিত কৈল নিবেদনে ॥ ২৮৪ ॥

śuni' saba bhakta kahe prabhura caraṇe
hearing all the devotees say the Lord's at the feet
sabākāra icchā paṇḍita kaila nivedane
of everyone the desire the Paṇḍita has made submission

284 Hearing this, all the devotees said at the Lord's feet, "The Paṇḍita has put forward what we all desire."

At everyone's wish the Lord stays in Purī for four months —

সবার ইচ্ছায় প্রভু চারিমাস রহিলা ।
শুনিয়া প্রতাপরুদ্র আনন্দিত হৈলা ॥ ২৮৫ ॥

sabāra icchāya prabhu cārimāsa rahilā
everyone's by the desire the Lord four months stayed
śuniyā pratāparudra ānandita hailā
hearing Pratāparudra delighted became

285 At everyone's wish the Lord stayed for the four months, and when Pratāparudra heard this, he was delighted.

The Paṇḍita feeds the Lord at his own home in Ṭoṭā —

সেই দিন গদাধর কৈল নিমন্ত্রণ ।
তাঁহা ভিক্ষা কৈল প্রভু লঞা ভক্তগণ ॥ ২৮৬ ॥

sei dina gadādhara kaila nimantraṇa
that day Gadādhara made invitation
tāṁhā bhikṣā kaila prabhu lañā bhakta-gaṇa
there meal took the Lord taking the devotees

286 That day Gadādhara invited Him, and the Lord took His meal there with the devotees.

The Paṇḍita's love and the Lord's submission to it are inconceivable for mortals —

ভিক্ষাতে পণ্ডিতের স্নেহ, প্রভুর আস্বাদন ।
মনুষ্যের শক্ত্যে দুই না যায় বর্ণন ॥ ২৮৭ ॥

bhikṣāte paṇḍitera sneha, prabhura āsvādana
at the meal the Paṇḍita's affection the Lord's relishing
manuṣyera śaktye dui nā yāya varṇana
by human power the two not can be described

287 No human being could describe the Paṇḍita's affection at that meal, or how the Lord relished it.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The love that Gadādhara Paṇḍita showed when he fed the Lord, and the way the Lord relished that loving *prasāda* — neither can be described by human power.

Thus ends the sixteenth chapter of the "Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya."

এই মত গৌরলীলা — অনন্ত, অপার ।
সংক্ষেপে কহিয়ে, কহা না যায় বিস্তার ॥ ২৮৮ ॥

ei mata gaura-līlā — ananta, apāra
in this way the pastimes of Gaura endless boundless
saṅkṣepe kahiye, kahā nā yāya vistāra
in brief I tell; to tell not goes in full

288 Such are Gaura's pastimes, endless and boundless. I tell them in brief, for they cannot be told in full.[9]

Even Ananta Himself cannot find the end of Gaura's pastimes —

সহস্র-বদনে কহে আপনে 'অনন্ত' ।
তবু এক লীলার তেঁহো নাহি পায় অন্ত ॥ ২৮৯ ॥

sahasra-vadane kahe āpane 'ananta'
with a thousand mouths tells Himself Ananta
tabu eka līlāra teṁho nāhi pāya anta
still of one pastime He not reaches the end

289 Ananta Himself tells of them with His thousand mouths, yet He cannot reach the end of even one pastime.

Anubhāṣya.

Thus ends the sixteenth chapter of the "Anubhāṣya."

শ্রীরূপ-রঘুনাথ-পদে যার আশ ।
চৈতন্যচরিতামৃত কহে কৃষ্ণদাস ॥ ২৯০ ॥

śrī-rūpa-raghunātha-pade yāra āśa
Śrī Rūpa's, Raghunātha's at the feet whose hope
caitanya-caritāmṛta kahe kṛṣṇadāsa
"Caitanya-caritāmṛta" narrates Kṛṣṇadāsa

290 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.[10]

Notes

1. The same verse as Madhya 4.2, 6.2 and 12.2 (the refrain of Ādi 4.2 with *gauracandra* in the first line); translation as there. ↩
2. *Tāṅhāra* ("his" or "her") is taken as referring to the wife: verses 21–25 speak of the devotees' wives (heading in the edition: "the journey of Candraśekhara's wife"). ↩
3. The first line is the second line of Madhya 1.96. ↩
4. The first line is the same as in Madhya 3.217, 5.140 and 15.13 (and in verse 81 of this chapter). ↩
5. In the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition — *kariha* ("bathe"): the king tells his men to bathe there every day, and for himself wishes to leave his body there. ↩
6. The second line is the same as in Madhya 6.286; the translation is brought into line with it. ↩
7. The second line is the same as in verses 56 and 81 of this chapter. ↩
8. The edition (p. 620) puts the father's words in quotation marks ('śīghra āsiha phiriyā'); the closing mark, lost in the base text, has been restored. ↩
9. The second line is the same as in Ādi 13.53. ↩
10. The verse = Madhya 7.155 (the closing refrain); the translation is the same as there. ↩
11. So in the edition (*ācāryanidhi*); in verse 81 the sense points to Puṇḍarīka Vidyānidhi (compare the *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya* on 76). ↩
12. In the edition couplet 204 has no number (only "॥" at the end; scan checked). ↩
13. In the edition (scan checked) the next couplet, 232, is numbered "১৩২" instead of "২৩২." ↩
14. In the standard numbering, *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu* 1.2.256 (on *phalgu-vairāgya*) and 1.2.255 (on *yukta-vairāgya*). ↩

15. So in the edition (scan checked): “২৬০.” By its content the section belongs to verse 264 (the Lord's instruction to Rūpa and Sanātana); in the edition it stands between sections 244 and 271. ↩
16. In the edition couplet 267 has no number (only “ ॥ ” at the end; scan checked). ↩
17. In the edition (scan checked) couplet 276 is numbered “১৭৬” instead of “২৭৬.” ↩
18. The edition does not give the source; this is *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.82.48 (= Madhya 13.136). ↩
19. So in the edition (scan checked): “ভা ১০ । ৮৪ । ৮”; in the standard numbering, *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.84.13. ↩
20. The edition does not give the source; this is *Brahma-saṁhitā* 5.38. ↩